

- 1 (a) Define the radian.

.....
 [1]

- (b) A circular metal disc spins horizontally about a vertical axis, as shown in Fig. 1.1.

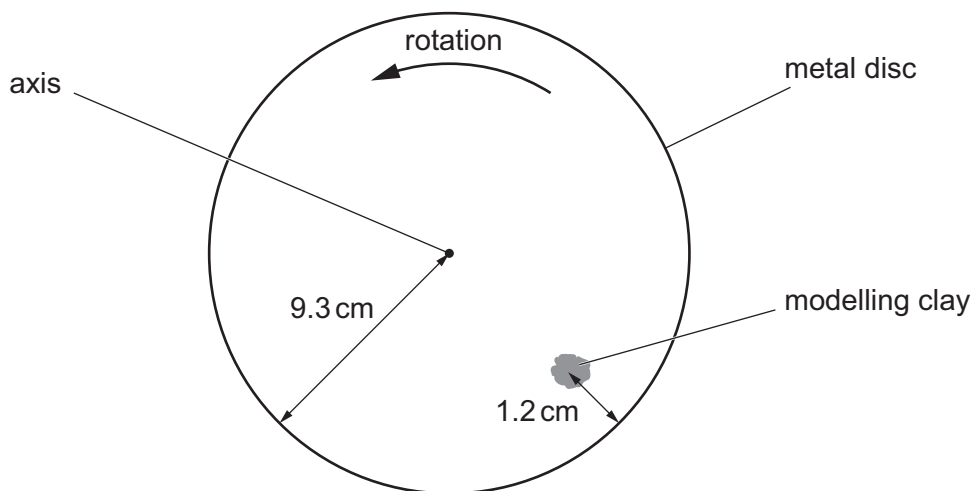


Fig. 1.1 (not to scale)

A piece of modelling clay is attached to the disc.

For the instant when the piece of modelling clay is in the position shown, draw on Fig. 1.1:

- (i) an arrow, labelled V , showing the direction of the velocity of the modelling clay [1]
- (ii) an arrow, labelled A , showing the direction of the acceleration of the modelling clay. [1]
- (c) The metal disc in Fig. 1.1 has a radius of 9.3 cm.
 The centre of gravity of the modelling clay is 1.2 cm from the rim of the disc and moves with a speed of 0.68 m s^{-1} .
- (i) Calculate the angular speed ω of the disc.

$\omega = \dots\dots\dots \text{ rad s}^{-1}$ [2]





(ii) Calculate the acceleration a of the centre of gravity of the modelling clay.

$a = \dots\dots\dots \text{ms}^{-2}$ [2]

(d) A second piece of modelling clay is attached to the disc in the position shown in Fig. 1.2.

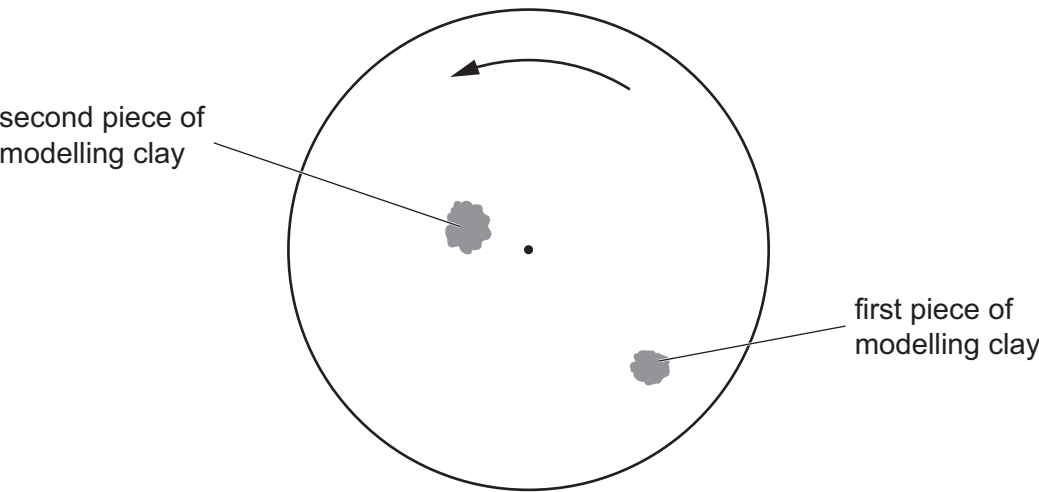


Fig. 1.2

The second piece of modelling clay has a larger mass than the first piece.

By placing **one** tick (✓) in each row, complete Table 1.1 to show how the quantities indicated compare for the two pieces of modelling clay.

Table 1.1

quantity	less for second piece than first piece	same for both pieces	greater for second piece than first piece
angular speed			
linear speed			
acceleration			

[3]

[Total: 10]



- 2 (a) Explain why the gravitational potential near to a point mass is negative.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A planet may be assumed to be a uniform sphere. It has gravitational potential ϕ at distance r from the centre of the planet.

The variation with $\frac{1}{r}$ of ϕ is shown in Fig. 1.1.

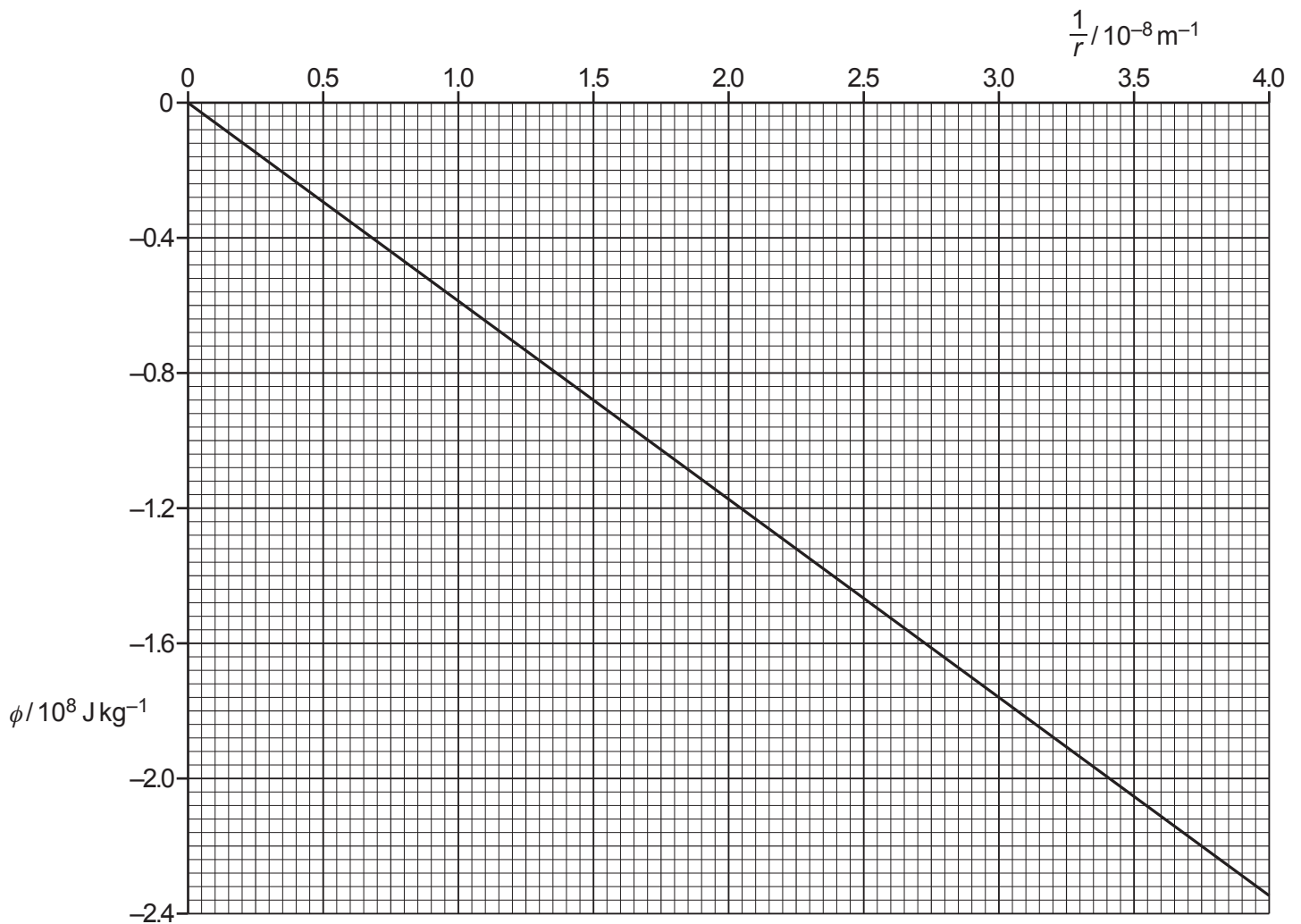


Fig. 1.1

2024 Paper 4 Questions by Topic

- (i) Show that the mass of the planet is 8.8×10^{25} kg.

[2]

- (ii) The period of rotation of the planet is 0.72 Earth days.

A satellite in orbit around the planet remains above the same point on the surface of the planet.

Use the mass of the planet in **(b)(i)** to determine the radius R of the orbit of the satellite.

$R = \dots\dots\dots$ m [3]

- (iii) The speed of the satellite in **(b)(ii)** is 8400 ms^{-1} . The mass of the satellite is 1200 kg.

Determine the additional energy required to move the satellite from its orbit to infinity.

energy required = $\dots\dots\dots$ J [3]

[Total: 10]

- 3 (a) Define gravitational potential at a point.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A satellite X, of mass M , orbits a planet at a constant distance $4R$ from the centre of the planet, as shown in Fig. 1.1.

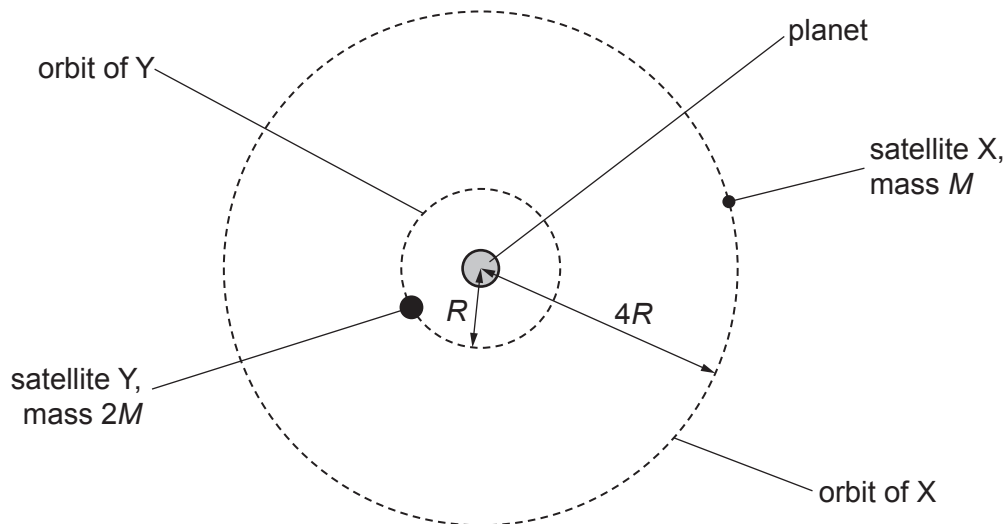


Fig. 1.1 (not to scale)

A second satellite Y, of mass $2M$, orbits the planet with orbital radius R .

The gravitational potential at X due to the planet is $-\Phi$. The planet is a uniform sphere.

- (i) Explain why the gravitational potential at X is negative.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (ii) State an expression, in terms of Φ , for the gravitational potential at Y due to the planet.

gravitational potential = [2]

(iii) Complete Table 1.1 by giving expressions, in terms of some or all of M , R and Φ , for the quantities indicated for each of the satellites X and Y.

Table 1.1

	satellite X	satellite Y
gravitational field strength at satellite due to planet		
gravitational potential energy of satellite		

[4]

[Total: 10]

- 4 (a) State Newton's law of gravitation.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A planet may be considered as a uniform sphere.

A satellite is in circular orbit of period T around the planet at a height h above the surface. The height of the orbit can be adjusted by use of the satellite's rocket engines.

Fig. 1.1 shows the variation with h of $T^{\frac{2}{3}}$.

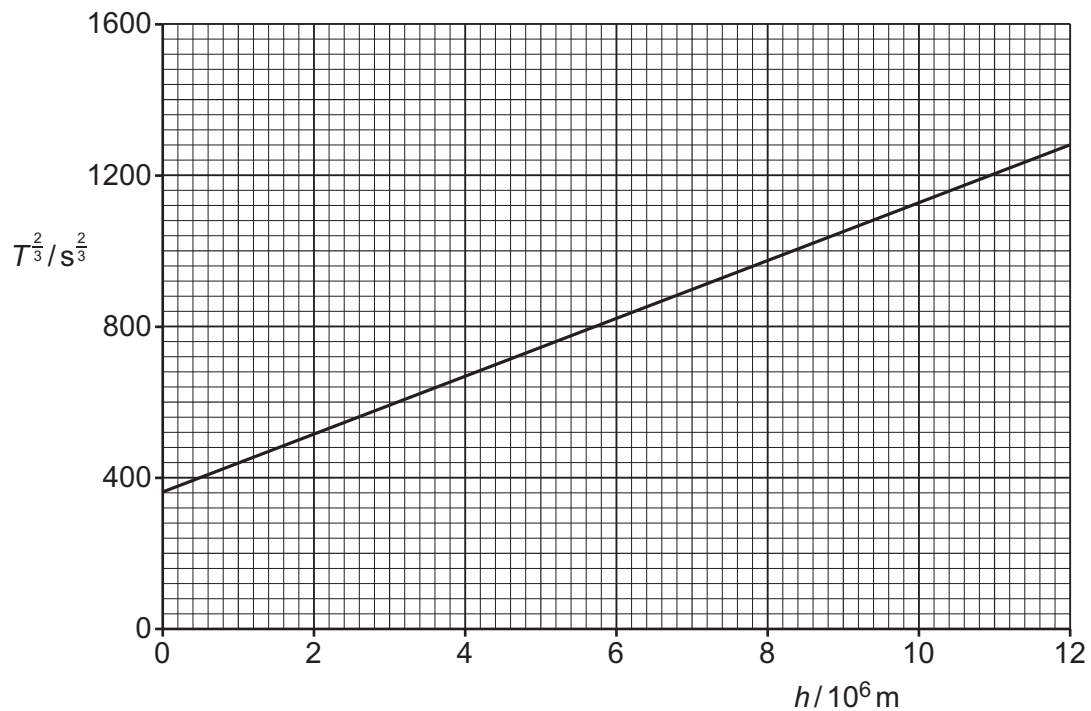


Fig. 1.1

- (i) By reference to forces, explain why the orbit of the satellite is circular.

.....

.....

..... [2]



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(ii) Use Newton's law of gravitation to show that h and T are related by

$$(h + B)^3 = \frac{GA}{4\pi^2} T^2$$

where G is the gravitational constant and A and B are constants that depend on the properties of the planet.

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[3]

(iii) Use the gradient and intercept of the line in Fig. 1.1 to determine values for A and B . Give units with your answers.

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$A = \dots\dots\dots$ unit $\dots\dots\dots$
 $B = \dots\dots\dots$ unit $\dots\dots\dots$
[5]

[Total: 12]

- 5 The Sun may be considered as a uniform sphere with a mass of $1.99 \times 10^{30} \text{ kg}$ and a surface temperature of 5780 K.

A probe with a mass of 2.63 kg moves in a straight line towards the Sun.

When it is at a distance x from the centre of the Sun, the probe measures the gravitational field strength g due to the Sun and the radiant flux intensity F of radiation from the Sun.

- (a) Define gravitational field.

.....
 [1]

- (b) For the position of the probe where $x = 1.47 \times 10^{11} \text{ m}$:

- (i) calculate g

$$g = \dots\dots\dots \text{N kg}^{-1} \quad [2]$$

- (ii) determine the gravitational potential energy E_p of the probe.

$$E_p = \dots\dots\dots \text{J} \quad [2]$$

- (c) (i) Show that, for any particular value of x , the numerical values of g and F are related by

$$g = \frac{4\pi GM}{L} F$$

where M is the mass of the Sun, L is the luminosity of the Sun and G is the gravitational constant.

[3]





(ii) Fig. 2.1 shows the variation of g with F .

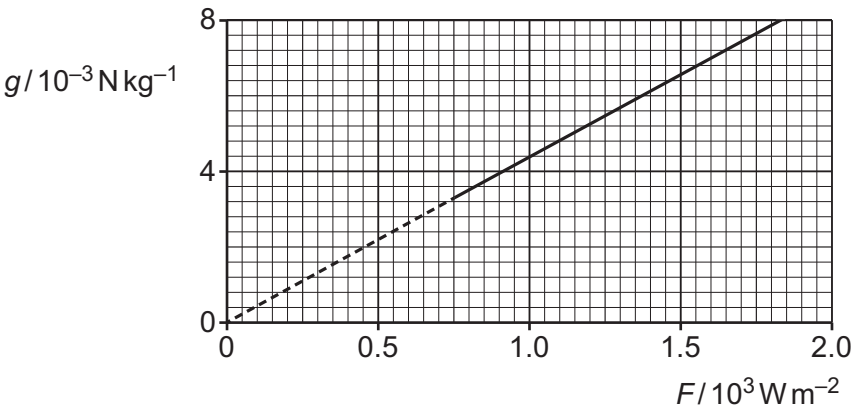


Fig. 2.1

Determine a value for the luminosity L of the Sun. Give a unit with your answer.

$L = \dots\dots\dots$ unit $\dots\dots\dots$ [2]

(iii) Use your answer in (c)(ii) to determine the radius r of the Sun.

$r = \dots\dots\dots$ m [2]

[Total: 12]





- 1 (a) Define specific heat capacity.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) Two solid blocks X and Y are made from different metals. The blocks have different initial temperatures. Block Y is initially at room temperature.

The blocks are placed in direct thermal contact with each other at time $t = 0$. Fig. 2.1 shows the variation with t of the temperatures of the two blocks.

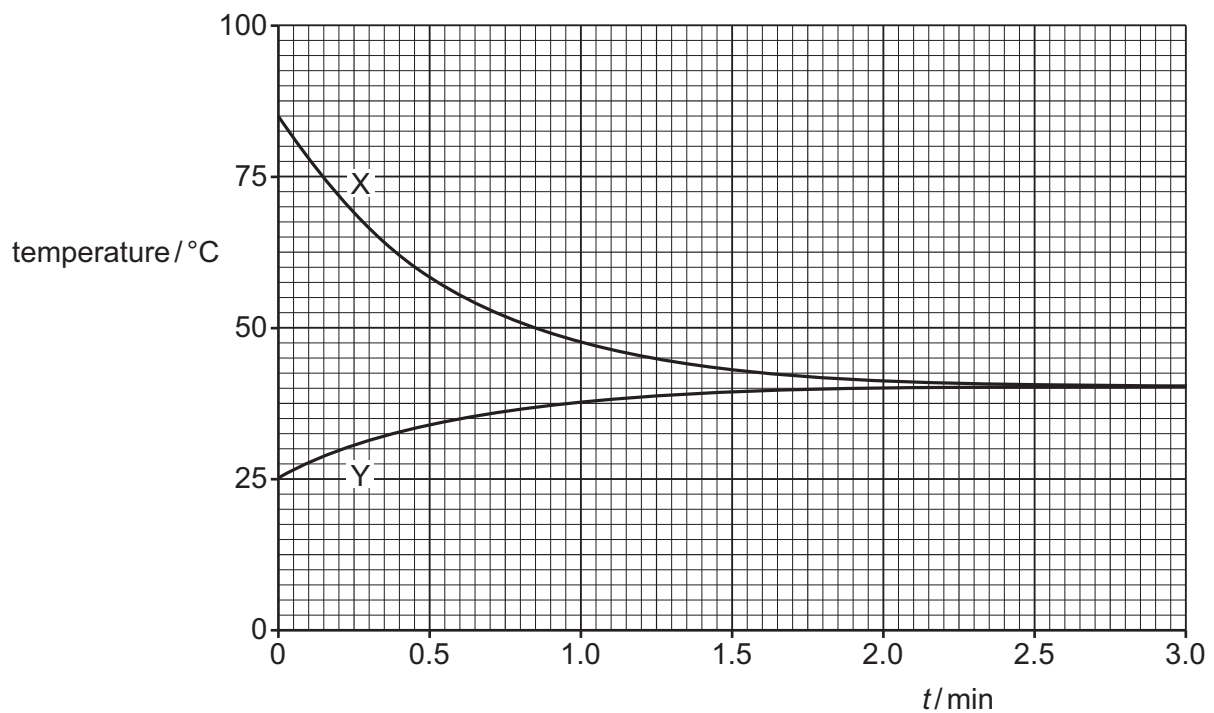


Fig. 2.1





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(i) State **three** conclusions that may be drawn from Fig. 2.1. The conclusions may be qualitative or quantitative.

1

.....

2

.....

3

.....

[3]

(ii) The ratio $\frac{\text{mass of block Y}}{\text{mass of block X}}$ is equal to 1.3.

The metal in block Y has a specific heat capacity of $901 \text{ J kg}^{-1} \text{ K}^{-1}$.

Determine the specific heat capacity of the metal in block X.

specific heat capacity = $\text{J kg}^{-1} \text{ K}^{-1}$ [3]

[Total: 8]





- 2 (a) Define specific latent heat.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A dish containing $7.2 \times 10^{-5} \text{ m}^3$ of a substance rests on a laboratory bench. The substance is initially a liquid of density 710 kg m^{-3} . Atmospheric pressure is $1.0 \times 10^5 \text{ Pa}$.

The liquid is heated at its boiling point so that it completely vaporises. The increase in the internal energy of the substance during this process is 17.6 kJ . The final volume of the vapour is 0.017 m^3 .

- (i) Show that the magnitude of the work done on the substance when it vaporises is 1.7 kJ .

[2]

- (ii) Use the information in (b)(i) to calculate the thermal energy Q , in kJ , supplied to the substance to cause it to vaporise.

$$Q = \dots\dots\dots \text{ kJ} \quad [2]$$

- (iii) Use your answer in (b)(ii) to determine a value for the specific latent heat of vaporisation L_v , in kJ kg^{-1} , of the substance.

$$L_v = \dots\dots\dots \text{ kJ kg}^{-1} \quad [2]$$





(c) The substance in (b) has a specific latent heat of fusion L_F .

Suggest and explain whether L_F is likely to be less than, the same as, or greater than the answer in (b)(iii).

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

[Total: 11]



- 3 (a) By referring to both kinetic energy and potential energy, explain what is meant by the internal energy of an ideal gas.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A fixed mass of an ideal gas at a temperature of 20°C is sealed in a cylinder by a piston, as shown in Fig. 2.1.

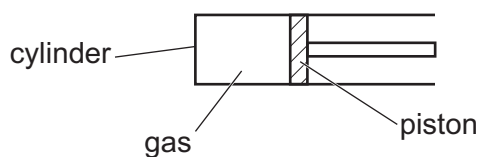


Fig. 2.1

The initial volume of the gas is $1.24 \times 10^{-4} \text{ m}^3$.

Thermal energy is supplied to the gas and its volume increases by $5.20 \times 10^{-5} \text{ m}^3$.

- (i) The piston is freely moving so that the gas is always at atmospheric pressure.

Atmospheric pressure is $1.01 \times 10^5 \text{ Pa}$.

Calculate the work done by the gas.

work done by gas = J [2]

- (ii) Calculate the final thermodynamic temperature T of the gas.

$T = \dots\dots\dots$ K [2]

- (iii) The mass of the gas is 16 g. For this expansion, there is a net transfer of 960 J of thermal energy to the gas.

Calculate the specific heat capacity c of the gas at this pressure.

$c = \dots\dots\dots$ J kg⁻¹ K⁻¹ [2]

- (c) The gas in (b) is allowed to return to its starting temperature. The piston is now fixed in position.

Thermal energy is supplied to increase the temperature to the same final temperature as in (b).

Use the first law of thermodynamics to suggest and explain how the specific heat capacity of the gas for this situation compares with the value in (b)(iii).

.....

 [3]

[Total: 11]

- 4 (a) (i) State what is meant by an ideal gas.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (ii) Use one of the basic assumptions of the kinetic theory to explain what can be deduced about the potential energy associated with the random motion of molecules in an ideal gas.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A sample of 0.26 m^3 of an ideal gas is at pressure $2.0 \times 10^5 \text{ Pa}$ and temperature 290 K .

Determine:

- (i) the number N of molecules of the gas

$$N = \dots\dots\dots [2]$$

- (ii) the average translational kinetic energy E_K of one molecule of the gas

$$E_K = \dots\dots\dots \text{ J } [2]$$

- (iii) the internal energy of the gas. Explain your reasoning.

$$\text{internal energy} = \dots\dots\dots \text{ J } [2]$$

(c) The volume V of the gas in (b) is now varied, keeping its pressure constant.

On Fig. 3.1, sketch the variation with V of the internal energy U of the gas.



Fig. 3.1

[2]

[Total: 12]



- 5 (a) With reference to thermal energy, state what is meant by two objects being in thermal equilibrium.

.....

 [1]

- (b) Two cylinders X and Y each contain a sample of an ideal gas. The samples are in thermal equilibrium with each other.

X has a volume of 0.0260 m^3 and contains 0.740 mol of gas at a pressure of $1.20 \times 10^5 \text{ Pa}$. Y has a volume of 0.0430 m^3 and contains gas at a pressure of $2.90 \times 10^5 \text{ Pa}$. Data for the two cylinders are shown in Fig. 2.1.



Fig. 2.1

- (i) Show that the temperature of the gas in X is 234°C .

[3]

- (ii) Determine the number N of molecules of the gas in Y. Explain your reasoning.

$N = \dots\dots\dots$ [3]





- (iii) The gas in X consists of molecules that each have a mass that is four times the mass of a molecule of the gas in Y.

Explain how the root-mean-square (r.m.s.) speed of the molecules in X compares with the r.m.s. speed of the molecules in Y.

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

[Total: 10]

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6 (a) (i) State what is meant by the Avogadro constant.

.....

.....

..... [1]

(ii) State the relationship between the Avogadro constant N_A , the molar gas constant R and the Boltzmann constant k .

[1]

(b) Two samples X and Y of ideal gases are both at thermodynamic temperature T .

Sample X has volume V and consists of N molecules, each of mass m .
Sample Y has volume $2V$ and consists of $2N$ molecules, each of mass $2m$.

(i) Complete Table 3.1 by giving expressions, in terms of some or all of N , m , T , V and the constants in (a)(ii), for the quantities indicated.

Table 3.1

	sample X	sample Y
pressure		
amount of substance		
mean-square speed of molecules		
internal energy		

[4]



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- (ii) The temperature of sample X is now varied.

On Fig. 3.1, sketch the variation with thermodynamic temperature of the root-mean-square (r.m.s.) speed of the molecules of the gas.

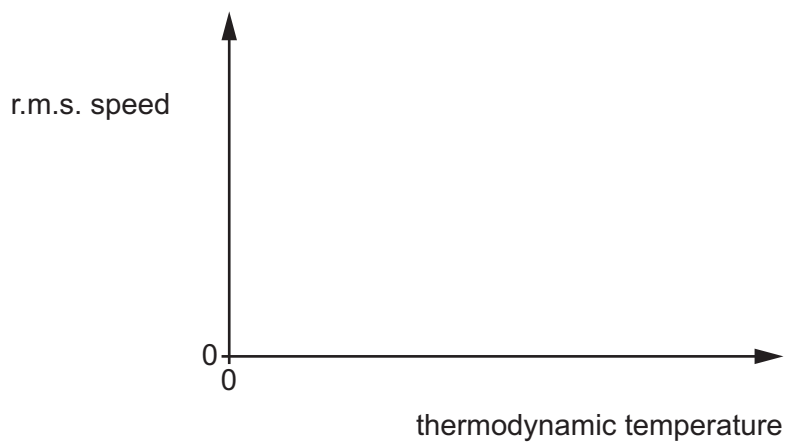


Fig. 3.1

[2]

[Total: 8]





- 7 (a) State **three** of the basic assumptions of the kinetic theory of gases.

1
.....
2
.....
3
..... [3]

- (b) Explain how molecular movement causes the pressure exerted by a gas.

.....
.....
.....
.....
..... [3]

- (c) Fig. 4.1 shows the variation with thermodynamic temperature T of the mean-square speeds $\langle c^2 \rangle$ for two gases X and Y.

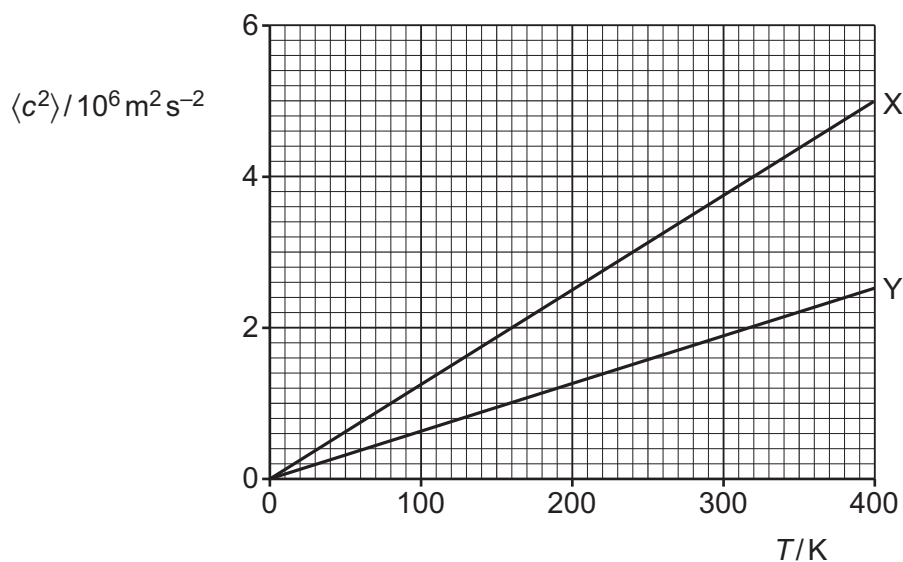


Fig. 4.1



Fig. 4.2 shows the variation with T of the product pV for samples of the two gases, where p is the pressure of the gas and V is the volume of the gas.

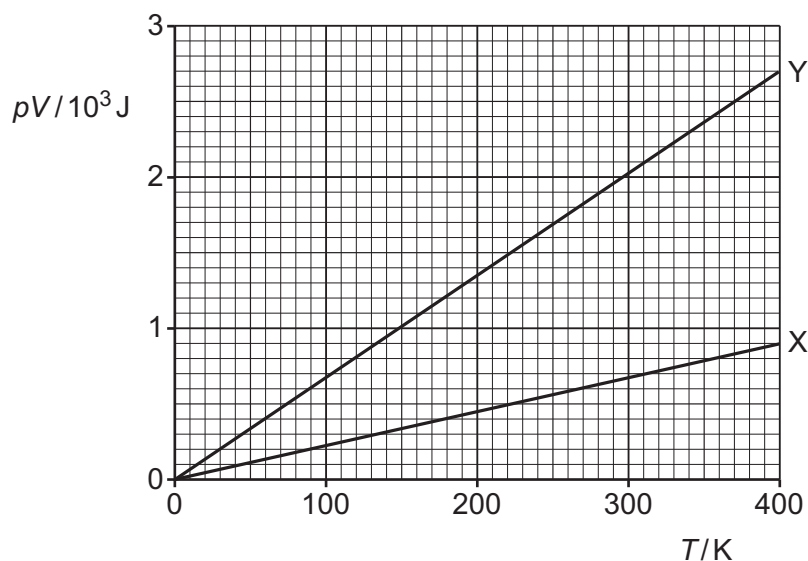


Fig. 4.2

State **three** conclusions about the gases and their samples that may be drawn from Fig. 4.1 and Fig. 4.2. The conclusions may be qualitative or quantitative. Use the space below for any working that you need.

- 1
- 2
- 3

[3]

[Total: 9]



- 8 (a) (i) State the magnitude and unit of absolute zero on the thermodynamic temperature scale.

..... [1]

- (ii) Explain why temperature measured using a laboratory liquid-in-glass thermometer does **not** give a measurement of thermodynamic temperature.

.....

..... [1]

- (b) Fig. 2.1 shows a simplified diagram of a type of thermometer called a platinum resistance thermometer.

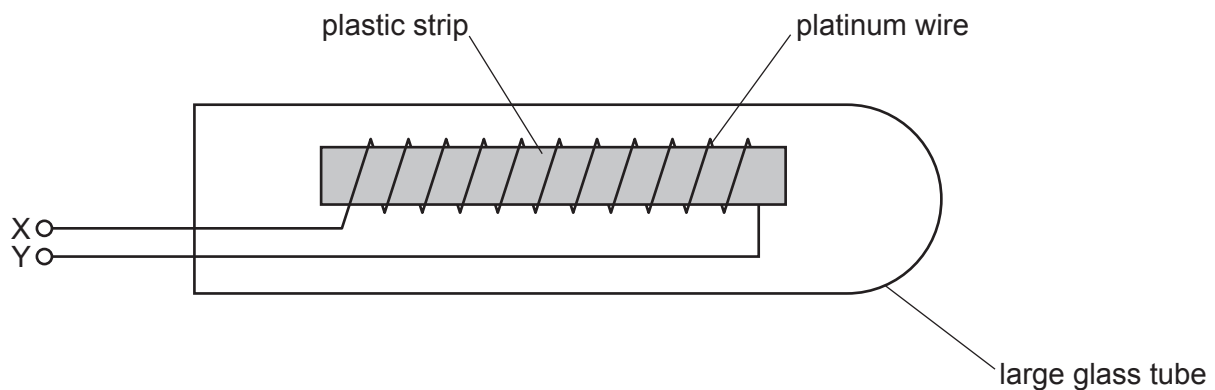


Fig. 2.1

The glass tube is immersed in the environment for which the temperature is to be determined. The resistance between the terminals X and Y is measured.

Fig. 2.2 shows the variation of the resistivity ρ of platinum with thermodynamic temperature T .

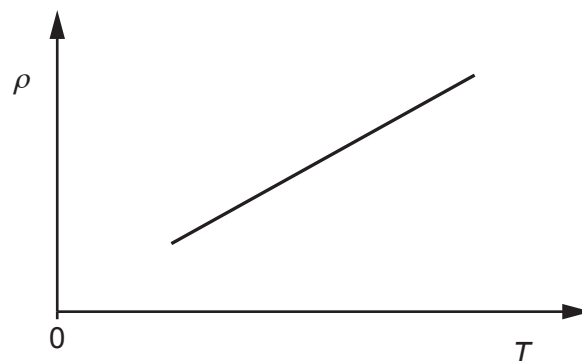


Fig. 2.2

- (i) Explain how Fig. 2.2 shows that platinum is a suitable metal for use in a resistance thermometer.

.....

 [2]

- (ii) Suggest a reason why a platinum resistance thermometer is **not** suitable for measuring a rapidly changing temperature.

.....

 [1]

- (iii) Suggest a type of thermometer that is suitable for measuring a rapidly changing temperature.

..... [1]

- (c) A negative temperature coefficient thermistor may be used as a type of resistance thermometer.

State **one** way in which the variation with temperature of the resistance of a thermistor differs from that of a platinum wire.

.....
 [1]

[Total: 7]



9 (a) State what is meant by the internal energy of a system.

.....

.....

..... [2]

(b) With reference to molecular kinetic and potential energies, describe and explain how the internal energy of the system changes when:

(i) a gas is heated at constant volume so that its temperature increases

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

(ii) a wire is stretched within its elastic limit at constant temperature.

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

[Total: 8]



- 1 A small object of mass 24 g rests on a platform. The platform is attached to an oscillator, as shown in Fig. 3.1.

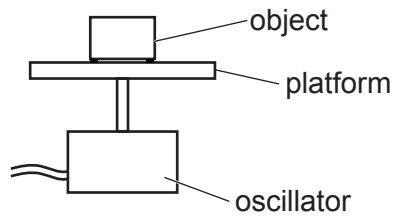


Fig. 3.1

The oscillator moves the platform up and down.

- (a) The total energy of the oscillations of the object is 2.2×10^{-4} J.
In one oscillation the object travels a total distance of 14 mm.

Calculate the angular frequency ω of the oscillations.

$$\omega = \dots\dots\dots \text{ rad s}^{-1} \quad [3]$$

- (b) The frequency of the oscillator is fixed, and the amplitude of the oscillations is gradually increased.
- (i) Calculate the maximum amplitude of the oscillations so the object does not lose contact with the platform.

$$\text{amplitude} = \dots\dots\dots \text{ m} \quad [2]$$

- (ii) The amplitude of the oscillations is increased so it is greater than the value in (b)(i).

State and explain the position in an oscillation where the object first loses contact with the platform.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

[Total: 7]

- 2 (a) State what is meant by resonance.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A small ball is held in place using a stretched string. One end of the string is fixed to a wall and the other end is attached to a vibration generator, as shown in Fig. 4.1.

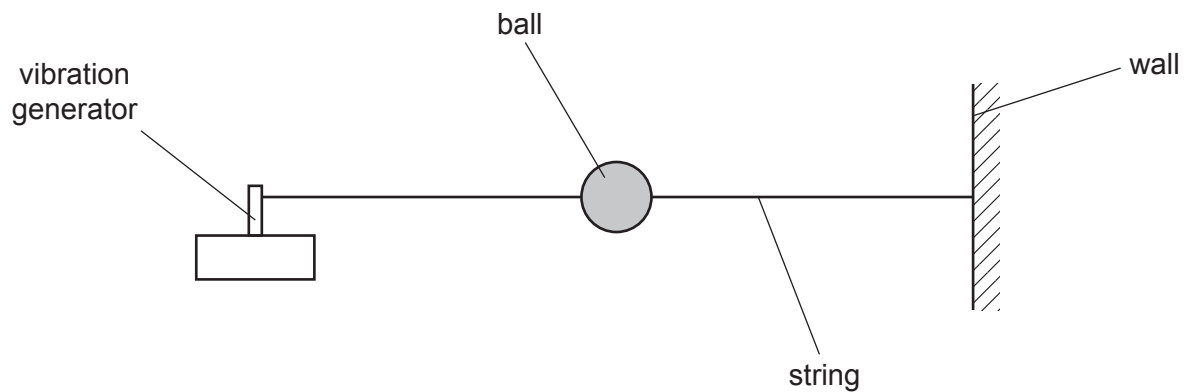


Fig. 4.1

Initially, the vibration generator is switched off.

A student displaces the ball vertically and then releases it. Fig. 4.2 shows the variation of the displacement of the ball with time after it is released.

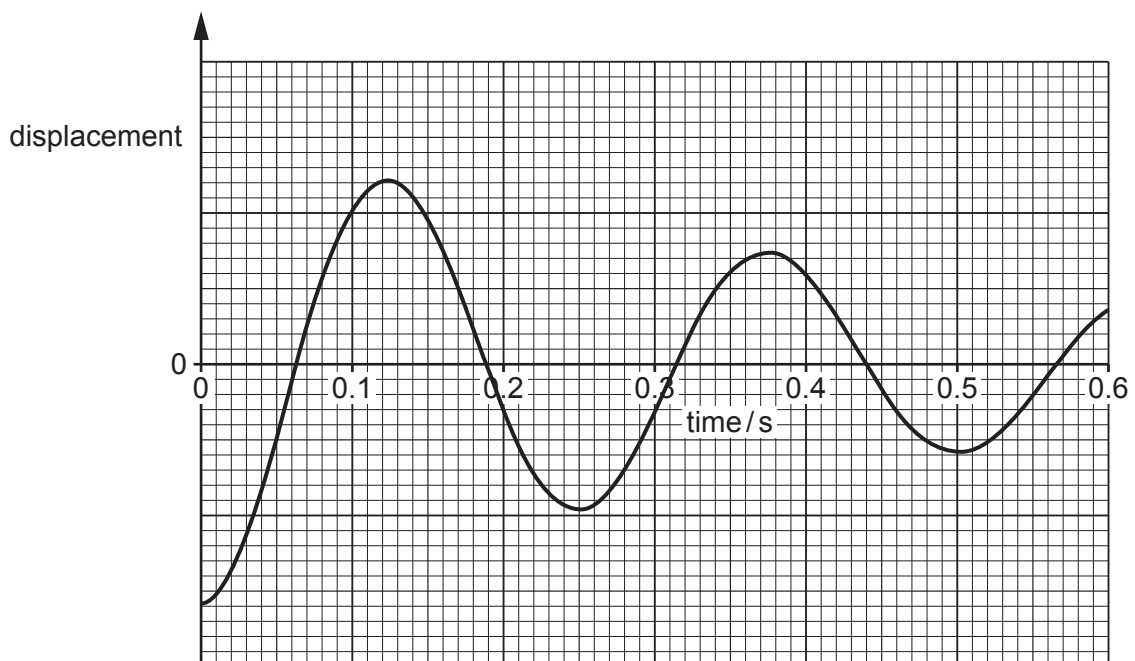


Fig. 4.2

- (i) State the name of the phenomenon illustrated by the decrease in the amplitude of the oscillations in Fig. 4.2.

..... [1]

- (ii) Explain the decrease with time of the amplitude of the oscillations of the ball.

.....

 [2]

- (iii) Determine the frequency of the oscillations of the ball.

frequency = Hz [1]

- (c) The vibration generator in (b) is switched on and its frequency f of vibration is gradually increased from 0 to 10 Hz.

On Fig. 4.3, sketch the variation with f of the amplitude of the oscillations of the ball.

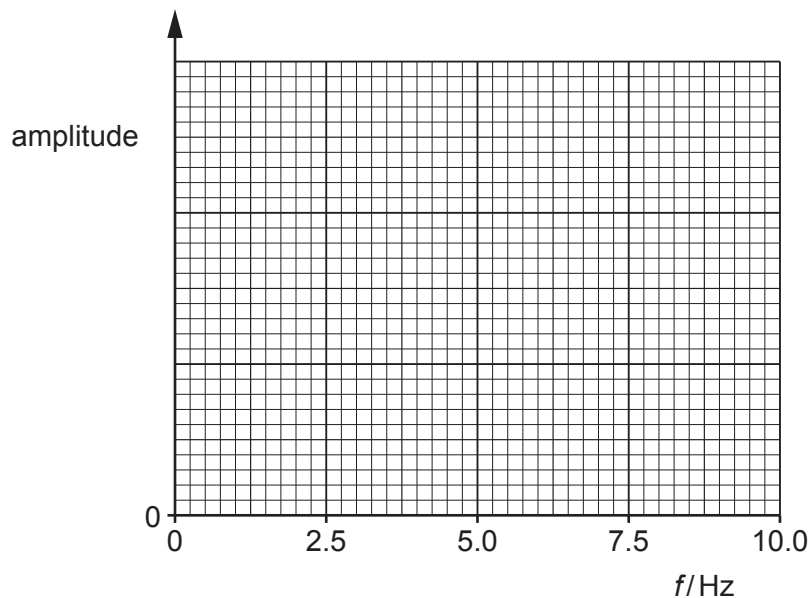


Fig. 4.3

[2]

[Total: 8]

- 3 A block of mass m oscillates vertically on a spring, as shown in Fig. 4.1.

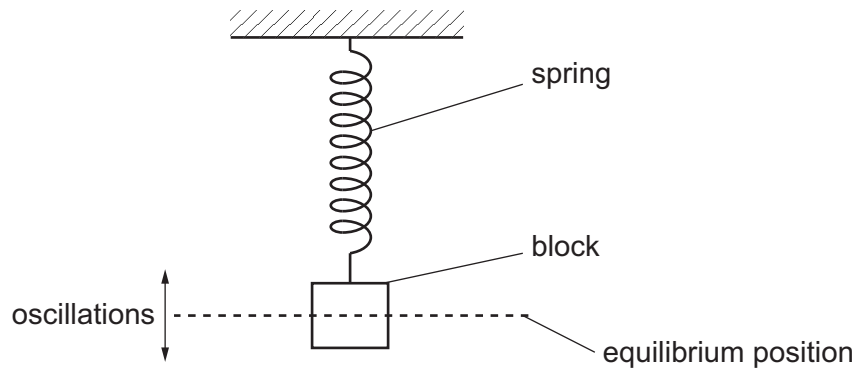


Fig. 4.1

The acceleration a of the block varies with displacement x from its equilibrium position, as shown in Fig. 4.2.

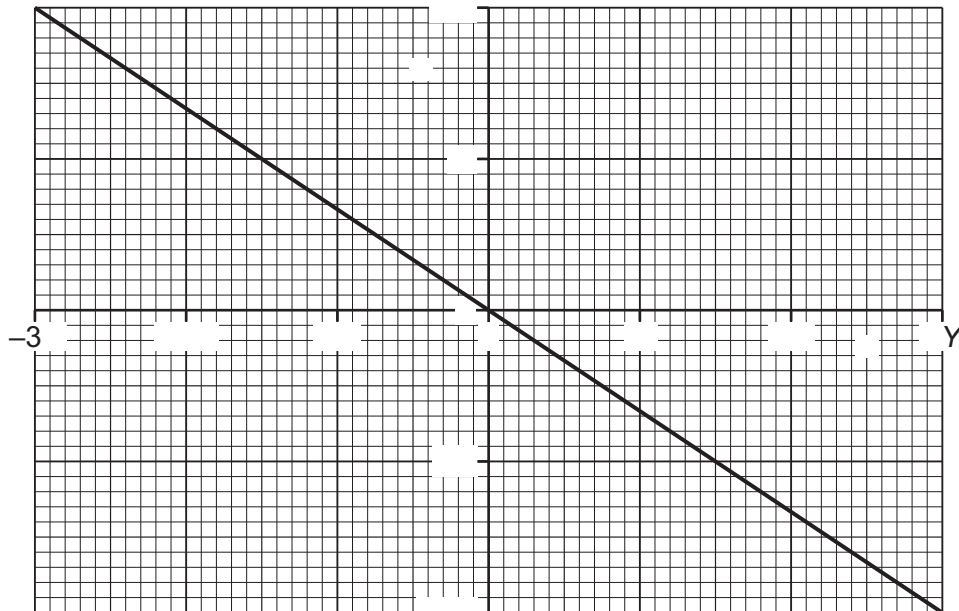


Fig. 4.2

The amplitude of the oscillations is $3Y$ and the maximum acceleration is $2A$.

- (a) Explain how Fig. 4.2 shows that the oscillations of the block are simple harmonic.

.....

.....

..... [2]



(b) Deduce expressions, in terms of some or all of m , A and Y , for:

(i) the angular frequency ω of the oscillations

$$\omega = \dots\dots\dots [1]$$

(ii) the maximum speed v_0 of the oscillations

$$v_0 = \dots\dots\dots [2]$$

(iii) the energy E of the oscillations.

$$E = \dots\dots\dots [2]$$

(c) The period of the oscillations is 0.75 s and the value of $3Y$ is 1.8 cm.

Determine an expression for x in terms of time t , where x is in cm and t is in seconds.

$$x = \dots\dots\dots [2]$$

[Total: 9]





- 4 (a) State what is meant by simple harmonic motion.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A block is suspended from a spring, as shown in Fig. 4.1.

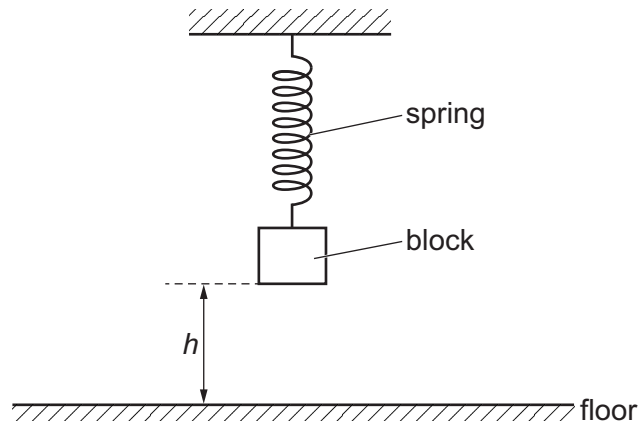


Fig. 4.1

The block is pulled down and released at time $t = 0$. It then oscillates vertically with simple harmonic motion.

Fig. 4.2 shows the variation of the velocity v of the block with height h of the base of the block above the floor.

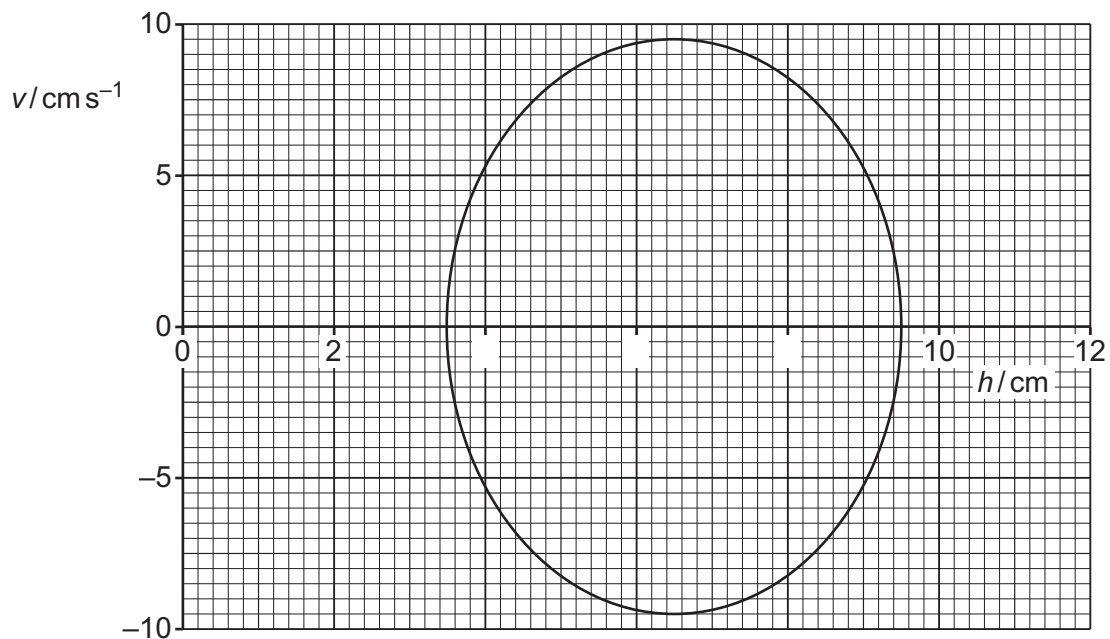


Fig. 4.2





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(i) Determine the amplitude, in cm, of the oscillations.

amplitude = cm [1]

(ii) Show that the angular frequency of the oscillations is 3.2 rad s^{-1} .

[2]

(iii) Calculate the period T of the oscillations.

$T = \dots\dots\dots$ s [2]

(iv) On Fig. 4.3, sketch the variation of h with time t from $t = 0$ to $t = 6.0\text{ s}$.

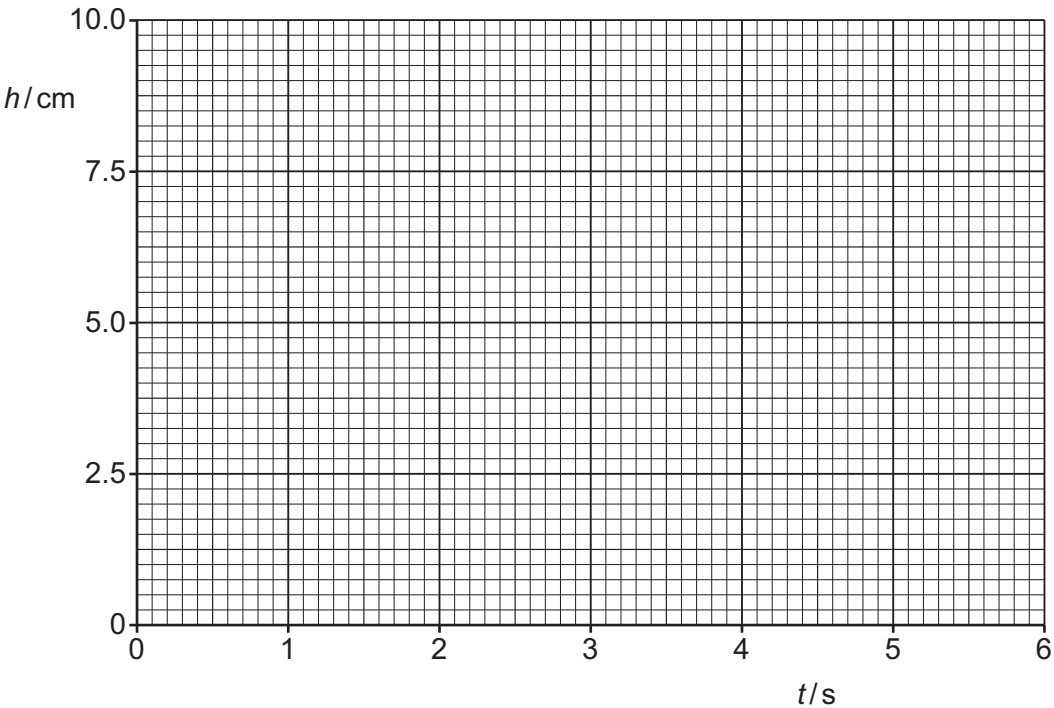


Fig. 4.3

[4]

[Total: 11]

[Turn over]



- 5 Fig. 5.1 shows a pendulum consisting of a metal sphere suspended by a thin string.

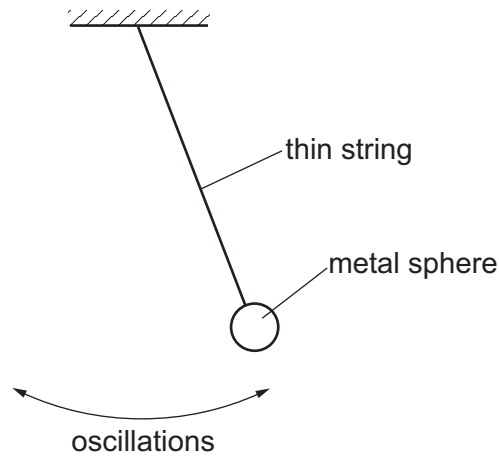


Fig. 5.1 (not to scale)

The sphere undergoes small oscillations about its equilibrium position. The oscillations may be considered to be simple harmonic.

Fig. 5.2 shows the variation with time t of the displacement x of the sphere from its equilibrium position.

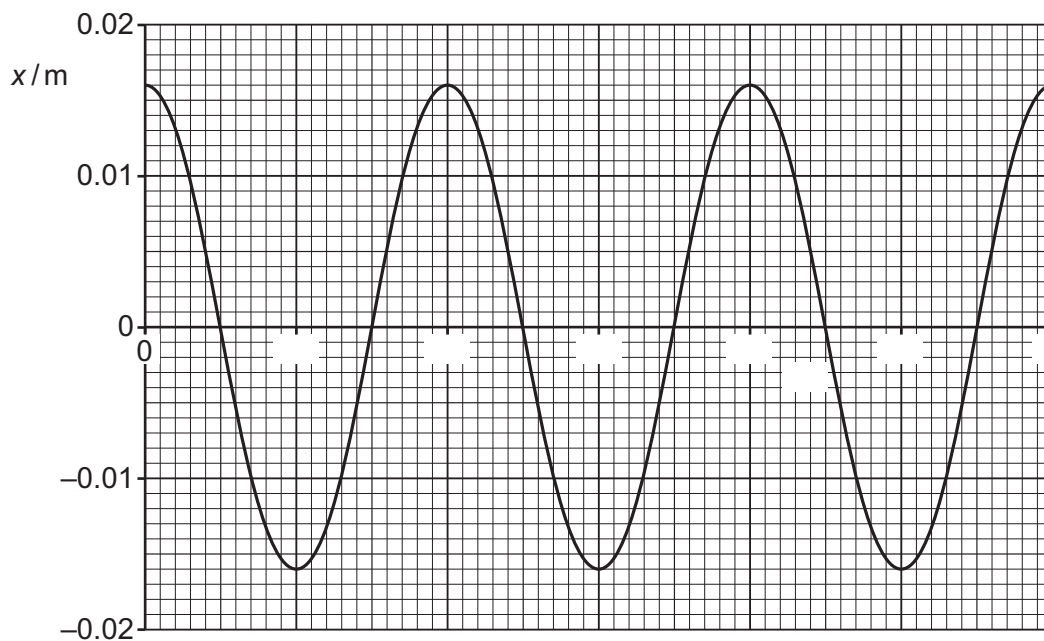


Fig. 5.2

- (a) On Fig. 5.1, draw an arrow, from the centre of the sphere, to represent the direction of the resultant force acting on the sphere when it is in the position shown. [1]





(b) The mass of the sphere is 0.15 kg.

(i) State the amplitude of the oscillations.

amplitude = m [1]

(ii) Determine the angular frequency of the oscillations.

angular frequency = rad s^{-1} [2]

(iii) Calculate the total energy of the oscillations.

total energy = J [2]

(c) On Fig. 5.3, sketch the variation with x of the kinetic energy E_K of the sphere.

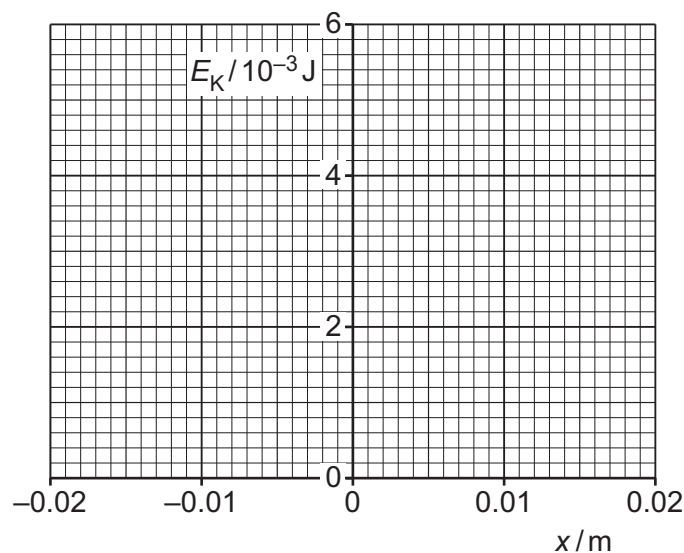


Fig. 5.3

[3]

[Total: 9]



- 1 (a) Define electric potential at a point.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) Two isolated charged metal spheres X and Y are near to each other in a vacuum. The centres of the spheres are 1.2 m apart, as shown in Fig. 5.1.

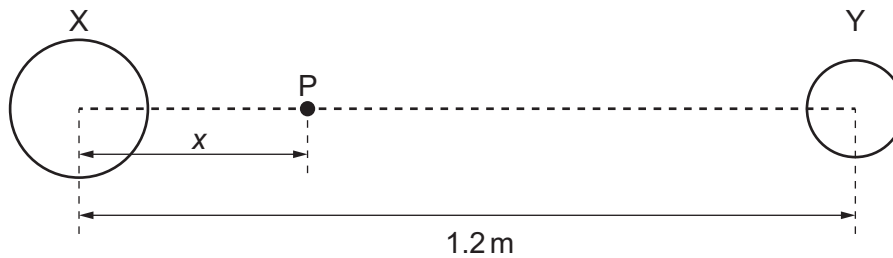


Fig. 5.1 (not to scale)

Point P is on the line joining the centres of spheres X and Y and is at a variable distance x from the centre of X.

Fig. 5.2 shows the variation with x of the total electric potential V due to the two spheres.

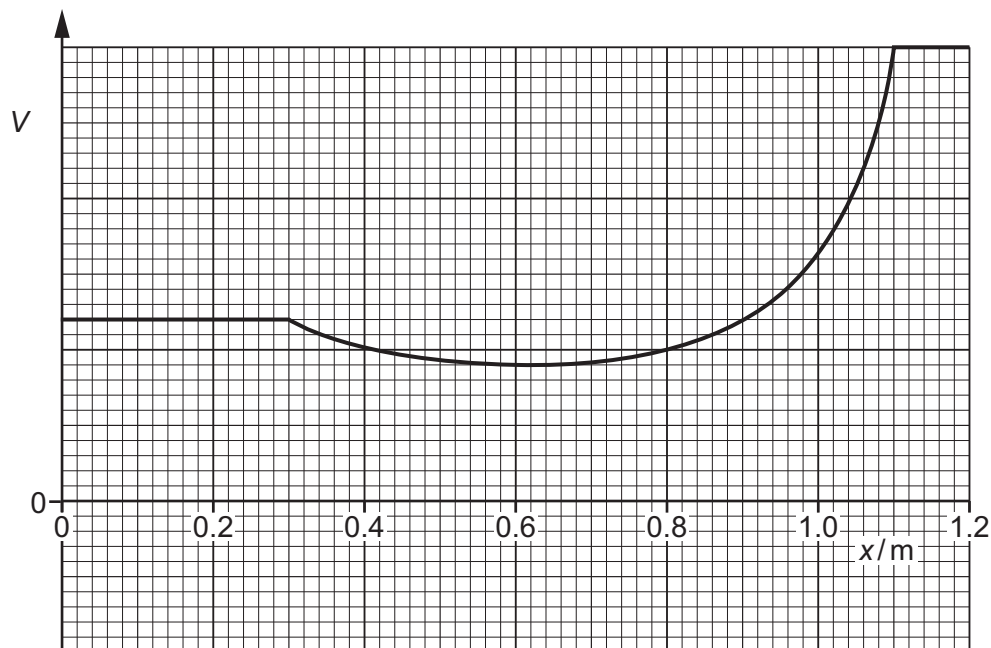


Fig. 5.2





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State **three** conclusions that may be drawn about the spheres from Fig. 5.2. The conclusions may be qualitative or quantitative.

1

.....

2

.....

3

.....

[3]

(c) A proton is held at rest on the line joining the centres of the spheres in (b) at the position where $x = 0.60\text{ m}$.

The proton is released.

Describe and explain, without calculation, the subsequent motion of the proton.

.....

.....

..... [2]

[Total: 7]





- 2 (a) State the relationship between electric field and electric potential.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) Two charged isolated insulating spheres X and Y are near to each other, as shown in Fig. 5.1.



Fig. 5.1

P is a point on the line joining the centres of the spheres.

Explain why it is **not** possible for the total electric potential and the resultant electric field to simultaneously be zero at point P.

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

- (c) The magnitudes of the charges on spheres X and Y in Fig. 5.1 are Q and $2Q$ respectively. The spheres may be considered as point charges at their centres.

Point P is a distance x from the centre of sphere X.

The electric potential at point P is zero.

- (i) Show that the distance y of point P from the centre of sphere Y is equal to $2x$.

[2]





- (ii) State an expression, in terms of Q , x and the permittivity of free space ϵ_0 , for the electric field strength E_x at P due to sphere X.

$$E_x = \dots\dots\dots [1]$$

- (iii) Determine an expression, in terms of Q , x and ϵ_0 , for the resultant electric field strength E at point P due to the two spheres.

$$E = \dots\dots\dots [2]$$

[Total: 10]





- 3 (a) State Coulomb's law.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) Fig. 6.1 shows an isolated hollow conducting sphere that is positively charged.

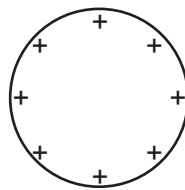


Fig. 6.1

On Fig. 6.1, draw field lines to represent the electric field outside the sphere. [3]

- (c) Fig. 6.2 shows the variation of the electric field strength E with distance x from the centre of the sphere in (b).

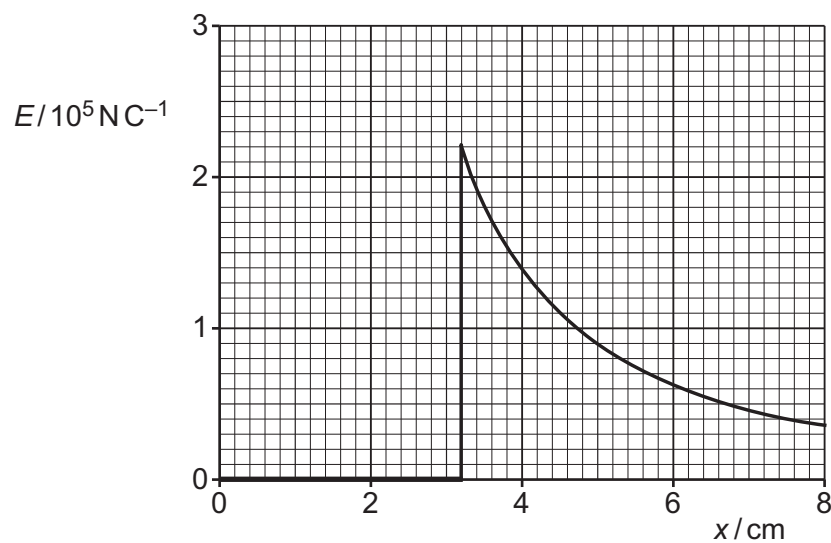


Fig. 6.2





(i) Determine the radius, in cm, of the sphere.

radius = cm [1]

(ii) Calculate the charge on the sphere.

charge = C [3]

(iii) Suggest an explanation for the fact that the electric field inside the sphere is zero.

.....
.....
..... [1]

[Total: 10]



- 1 Fig. 6.1 shows a capacitor of capacitance C connected in series with a resistor of resistance R .

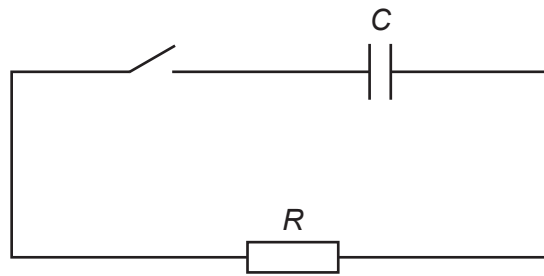


Fig. 6.1

Initially the switch is open and there is a p.d. of 12 V across the capacitor.

At time $t = 0$, the switch is closed so that there is a current I in the resistor.

Fig. 6.2 shows the variation of I with t .

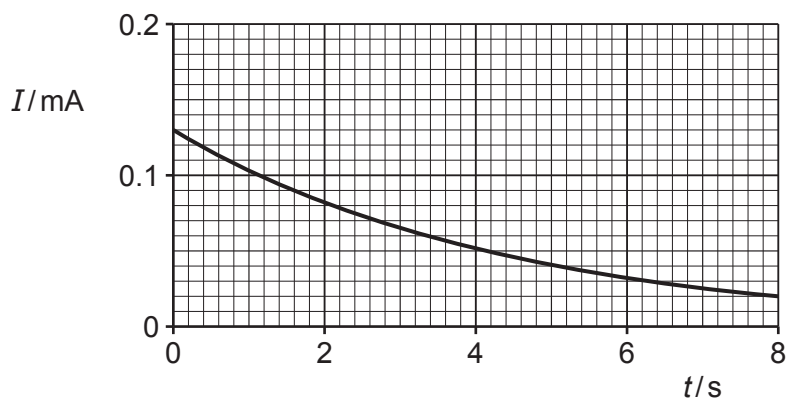


Fig. 6.2

- (a) Explain the shape of the line in Fig. 6.2.

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

(b) Use Fig. 6.2 to determine:

(i) resistance R

$$R = \dots\dots\dots \Omega \text{ [2]}$$

(ii) the time constant τ of the circuit in Fig. 6.1.

$$\tau = \dots\dots\dots \text{ s [3]}$$

(c) Use your answers in (b) to determine capacitance C .

$$C = \dots\dots\dots \text{ F [2]}$$

[Total: 10]



- 2 (a) Two capacitors X and Y are connected in series to a power supply of voltage V , as shown in Fig. 6.1.

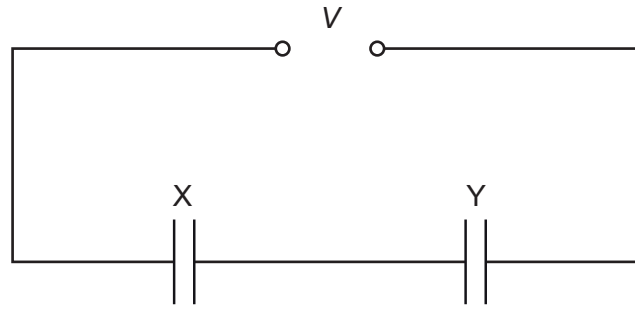


Fig. 6.1

The capacitance of X is C_X and the capacitance of Y is C_Y .

Derive an expression, in terms of C_X and C_Y , for the combined capacitance C_T of the capacitors in this circuit.
Explain your reasoning.

[3]

- (b) Two capacitors P and Q are connected in parallel to a power supply of voltage V .
The capacitance of P is $200\ \mu\text{F}$. The capacitance C_Q of Q can be varied between 0 and $400\ \mu\text{F}$.
When $C_Q = 0$, the total energy stored in the capacitors is $2.5\ \text{mJ}$.

- (i) Show that the supply voltage V is $5.0\ \text{V}$.

[2]





- (ii) Calculate the total energy, in mJ, stored in the capacitors when C_Q has its maximum value.

total energy = mJ [3]

- (iii) On Fig. 6.2, sketch the variation of the total energy E stored in the capacitors with C_Q , as C_Q varies from 0 to 400 μF .

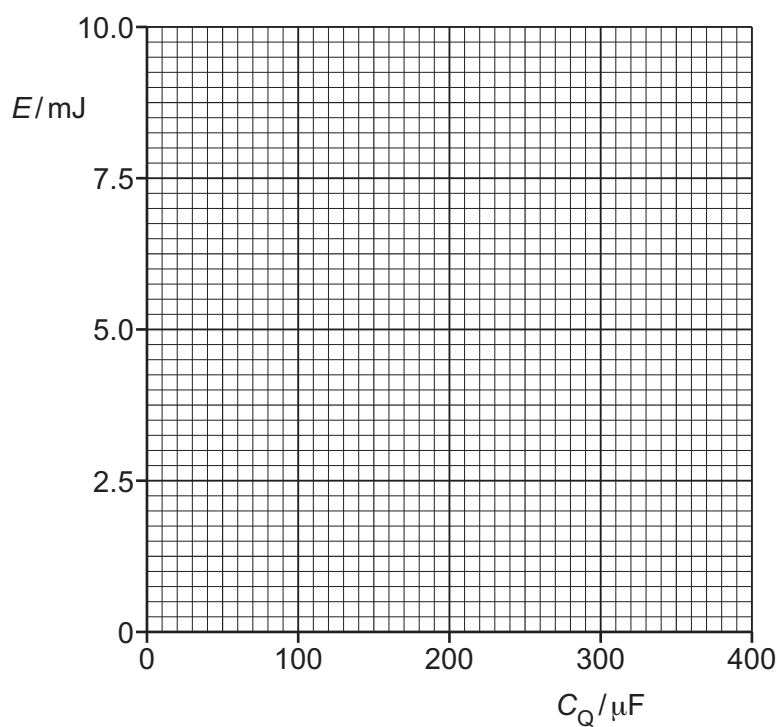


Fig. 6.2

[2]

[Total: 10]





- 3 (a) Define the capacitance of a parallel-plate capacitor.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) An initially uncharged capacitor X , of capacitance C , is gradually charged so that the final potential difference (p.d.) between its plates is V and the final charge is Q .

- (i) On Fig. 7.1, sketch the variation of charge with p.d. for capacitor X as the p.d. increases from 0 to V .

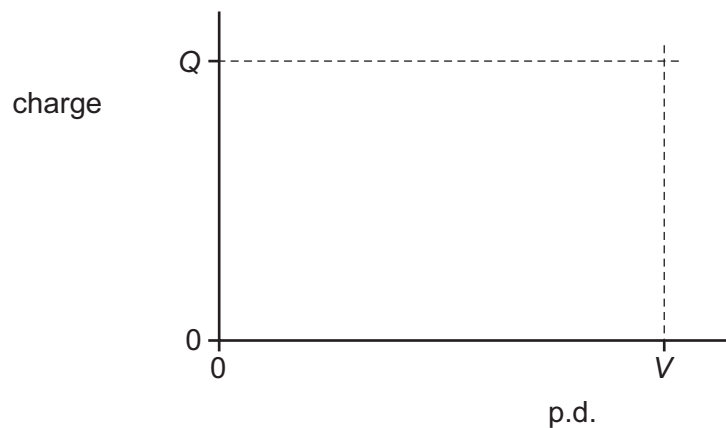


Fig. 7.1

[2]

- (ii) Determine an expression, in terms of Q and V , for the work W done on capacitor X during the charging process. Explain your reasoning.

$W =$ [2]





(c) Another capacitor Y is initially uncharged. The fully charged capacitor X in (b) is now connected to capacitor Y, as shown in Fig. 7.2.

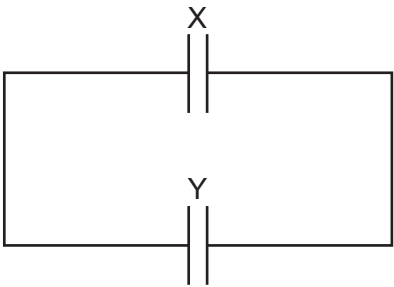


Fig. 7.2

The capacitance of capacitor Y is $3C$.

- (i) Complete Table 7.1 to show expressions, in terms of Q and V , for the final p.d.s across, and the final charges on, the two capacitors.
Use the space below for any working that you need.

Table 7.1

	X	Y
final p.d.		
final charge		

[3]

- (ii) State whether the total energy stored in the two capacitors is less than, the same as, or greater than the energy initially stored in capacitor X.

..... [1]

[Total: 10]





- 1 (a) Define magnetic flux density.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A long, straight wire carries a current into the page, as shown in Fig. 7.1.



Fig. 7.1

On Fig. 7.1, draw four field lines to represent the magnetic field around the wire due to the current in it. [3]

- (c) Two identical wires X and Y are placed parallel to each other. The wires both carry current into the page, as shown in Fig. 7.2.

X



Y



Fig. 7.2





- (i) Explain why the two wires exert a magnetic force on each other.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (ii) On Fig. 7.2, draw an arrow to show the direction of the magnetic force exerted on wire X. Label your arrow F. [1]

- (iii) The current in X is double the current in Y.

State how the magnetic force exerted on wire Y compares with the magnetic force exerted on wire X.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (iv) The direction of the current in both wires is now reversed.

State, with a reason, the effect of this change on the direction of the force on wire X.

.....

..... [1]

[Total: 11]



- 2 (a) An object travels in a circle at constant speed.

State the names of **two** quantities that vary during the motion of the object.

1

2 [2]

- (b) A charged particle of mass m and with charge q enters a region of uniform magnetic field, perpendicular to the field lines. The magnetic flux density is B .

The particle travels in a circle with period T and radius r .

- (i) By considering the magnetic force acting on the particle, show that

$$B = \frac{2\pi m}{qT}.$$

[3]

- (ii) The particle is an alpha particle. The period of the circular motion is $2.5\mu\text{s}$.

Calculate B .

$$B = \dots\dots\dots \text{T} \quad [2]$$

- (iii) A second alpha particle is in the same uniform field. It travels in a circle of radius $2r$.

State and explain how the periods of the motion of the two particles compare.

.....

.....

..... [1]

2024 Paper 4 Questions by Topic

- (iv) The speed of the alpha particle in (b)(ii) is $1.1 \times 10^6 \text{ m s}^{-1}$. An electric field is applied so that this particle now moves with constant velocity.

Use your answer in (b)(ii) to calculate the electric field strength E . Give the unit with your answer.

$E =$ unit [2]

[Total: 10]

- 3 (a) Define electric field.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) Fig. 5.1 shows two parallel conducting plates that are in a vacuum. The plates are separated by a distance of 6.7 cm and have a potential difference (p.d.) of 430 V between them.

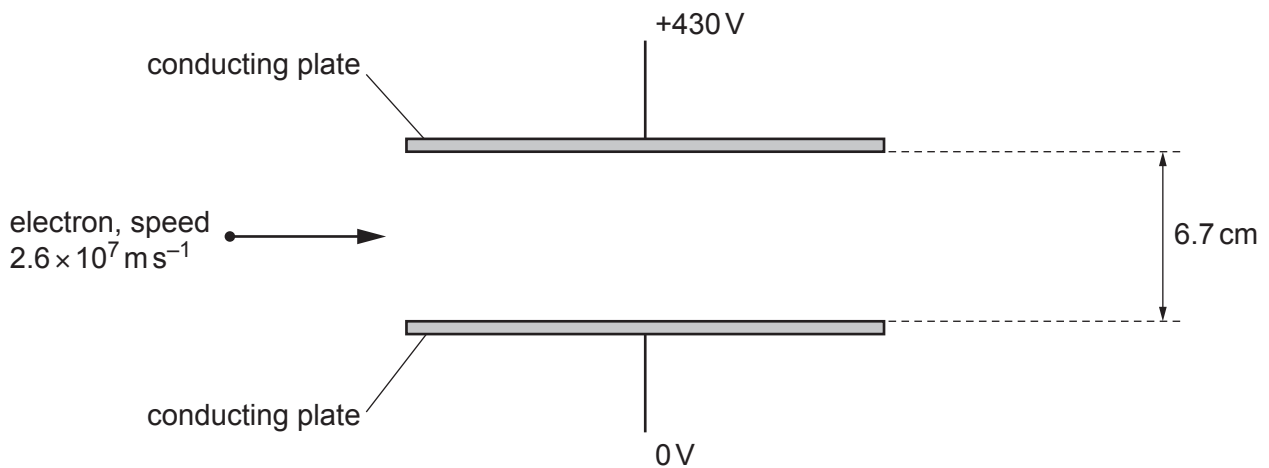


Fig. 5.1

- (i) On Fig. 5.1, draw four field lines to represent the electric field between the plates. [2]
- (ii) Determine the strength E of the electric field between the plates.

$$E = \dots\dots\dots \text{NC}^{-1} \text{ [2]}$$

- (iii) An electron travels at a speed of $2.6 \times 10^7 \text{ ms}^{-1}$ towards the region between the plates, as shown in Fig. 5.1.

On Fig. 5.1, draw the path of the electron as it moves between and beyond the plates. [2]

- (c) A uniform magnetic field is now applied in the region of the electric field in Fig. 5.1, so that the electron in (b)(iii) travels undeviated through the region.

- (i) Determine the direction of the uniform magnetic field.

..... [1]

- (ii) Explain, with reference to the forces exerted by the two fields on the electron, why the path of the electron is undeviated.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (iii) Determine the flux density B of the uniform magnetic field. Give a unit with your answer.

$B =$ unit [2]

[Total: 13]

- 4 (a) A small coil C has 64 turns and cross-sectional area 0.71 cm^2 . The coil is placed inside a solenoid as shown in Fig. 6.1.

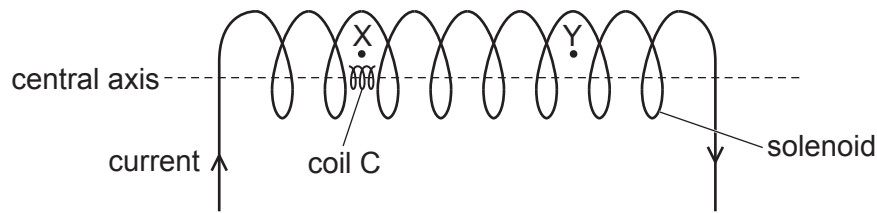


Fig. 6.1

The centre of coil C is on the central axis of the solenoid.

- (i) There is a constant current in the solenoid.
Coil C is moved through the solenoid from position X to position Y.

On Fig. 6.2, sketch a line to show the variation of the magnetic flux linkage in coil C with position as it moves from X to Y.

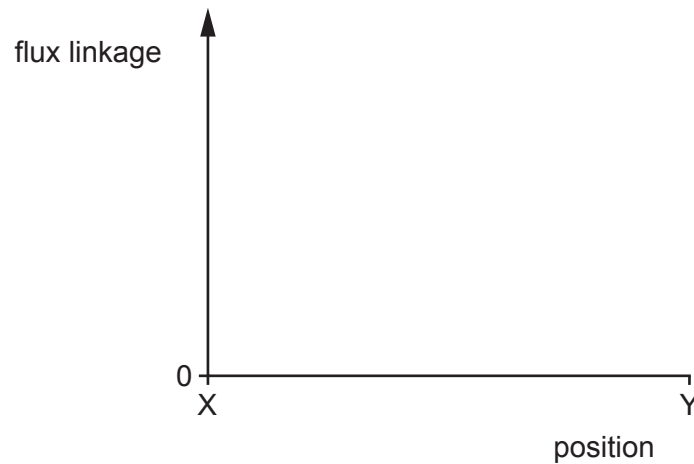


Fig. 6.2

[1]

- (ii) Explain the shape of your line in (a)(i).

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (iii) Coil C is now held stationary at X. The current in the solenoid varies so that the magnetic flux density B at X varies from time 0 to time $4t$ as shown in Fig. 6.3.

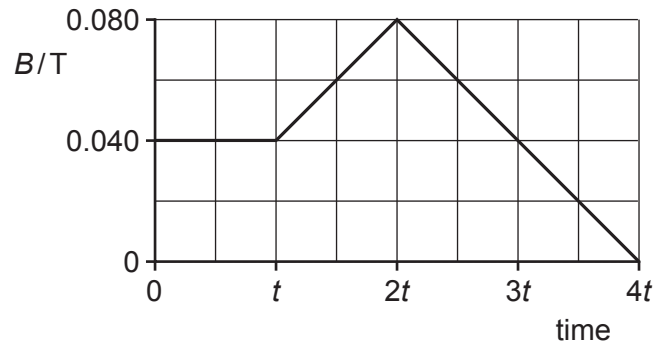


Fig. 6.3

Calculate the maximum magnetic flux linkage in coil C.

flux linkage = Wb [2]

- (iv) On Fig. 6.4, sketch a line to show the induced electromotive force (e.m.f.) E in coil C from time 0 to time $4t$.

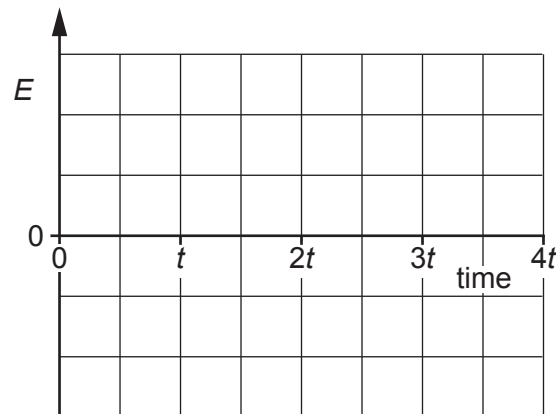


Fig. 6.4

[3]

- (b) A metal spring rests on a smooth table. The turns of the spring are equally spaced. The ends of the spring are connected to a d.c. power supply, as shown in Fig. 6.5.

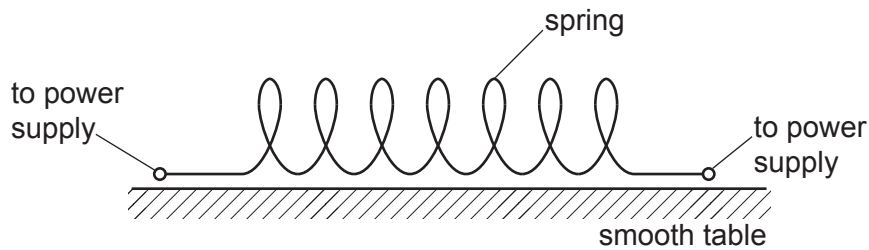


Fig. 6.5

The spring is connected to the d.c. power supply using flexible leads. The spring is not under tension.

With reference to magnetic fields, describe and explain the change in the distance between the turns of the spring when the power supply is first switched on.

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

[Total: 11]

- 5 (a) State Faraday's law of electromagnetic induction.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) Fig. 7.1 shows a coil at rest in a uniform magnetic field that is parallel to the axis of the coil.

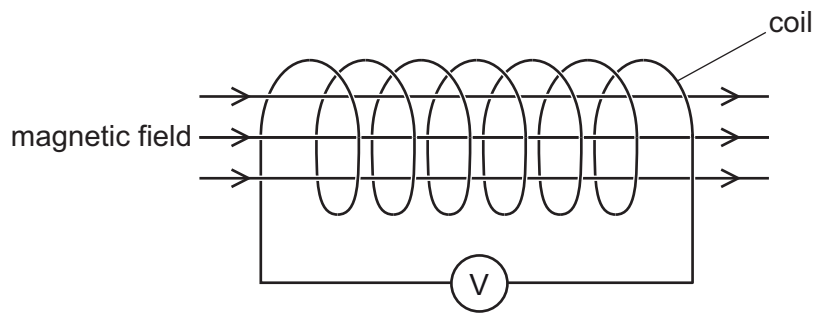


Fig. 7.1

The coil is connected to a centre-zero voltmeter.

The flux density B of the uniform magnetic field varies with time t as shown in Fig. 7.2.

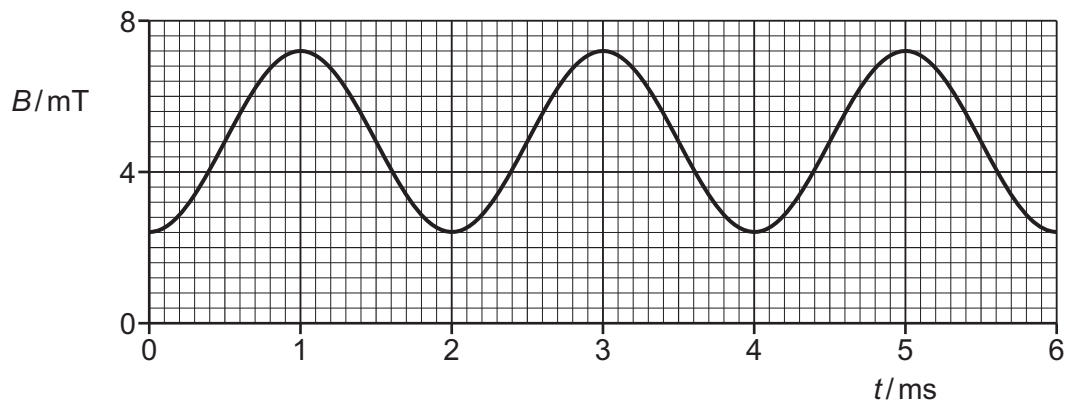


Fig. 7.2

The coil consists of 340 turns, each of cross-sectional area $3.2 \times 10^{-4} \text{ m}^2$.

- (i) Calculate the maximum magnetic flux through **one** turn of the coil.

maximum magnetic flux = Wb [2]



- (ii) Determine the maximum rate of change of magnetic flux linkage in the coil.

maximum rate of change of flux linkage = Wb s^{-1} [3]

- (iii) State the maximum electromotive force (e.m.f.) V_0 induced across the coil.

$V_0 = \dots\dots\dots \text{V}$ [1]

- (iv) On Fig. 7.3, sketch the variation of the e.m.f. V induced across the coil with t from $t = 0$ to $t = 6.0 \text{ ms}$.

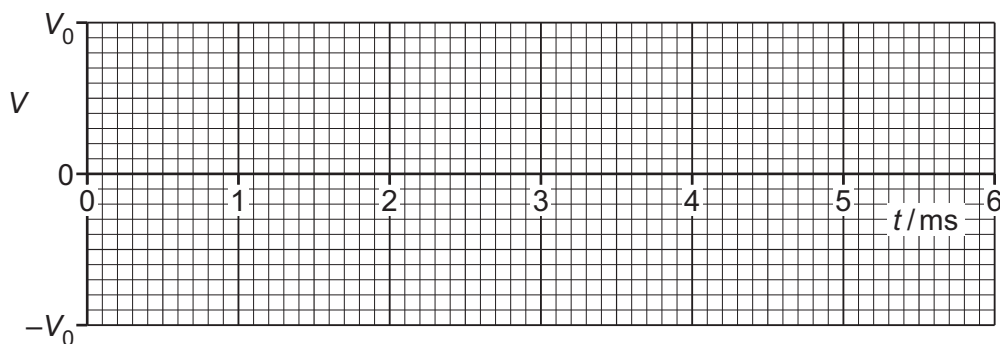


Fig. 7.3

[3]

- (v) The variation of V with t can be described by

$$V = A \sin Bt$$

where A and B are constants.

Determine the values of A and B . Give units with your answers.

$A = \dots\dots\dots \text{unit} \dots\dots\dots$

$B = \dots\dots\dots \text{unit} \dots\dots\dots$ [3]

[Total: 14]



- 6 A metal wheel consists of an axle A, eight spokes and a rim, as shown in Fig. 1.1.

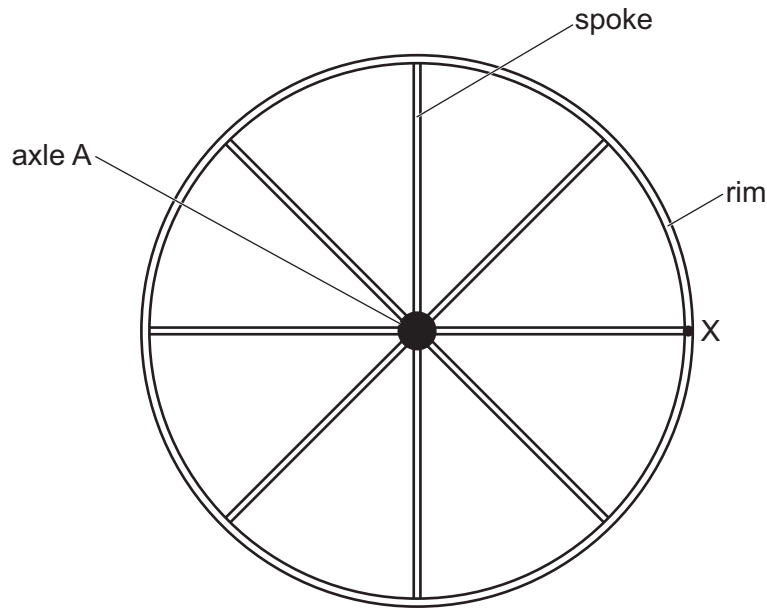


Fig. 1.1

Point X is on the rim at the end of one of the spokes.

The rim has a radius of 0.85 m.

The wheel is rotating clockwise with an angular speed of 140 rad s^{-1} .

(a) For point X, determine:

(i) the speed

speed = m s^{-1} [2]

(ii) the centripetal acceleration.

acceleration = m s^{-2} [2]





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(b) There is a uniform magnetic field of flux density 0.18 T into the plane of the page.

(i) State Lenz’s law of electromagnetic induction.

.....
.....
..... [2]

(ii) Show that the time taken for point X to complete one revolution is 45 ms.

[1]

(iii) Calculate the magnetic flux cut by spoke AX during one revolution of the wheel.
Give a unit with your answer.

magnetic flux = unit [3]

(iv) Determine the magnitude of the electromotive force (e.m.f.) induced across spoke AX.

induced e.m.f. = V [2]

(v) Use Lenz’s law to explain whether the potential is higher at end A or end X of the spoke.

.....
.....
..... [1]

[Total: 13]

[Turn over]



- 1 (a) Three capacitors are connected as shown in Fig. 4.1.

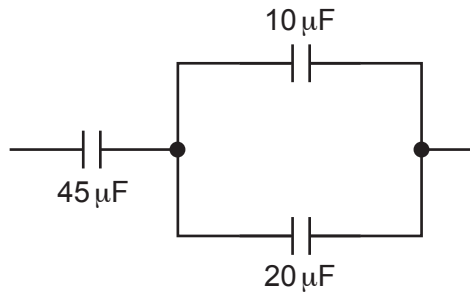


Fig. 4.1

Determine the total capacitance, in μF , of the network of three capacitors.

capacitance = μF [2]

- (b) A capacitor of capacitance $45\ \mu\text{F}$ is connected to a variable power supply initially set at $8.0\ \text{V}$. The output of the power supply increases so that the potential difference (p.d.) across the capacitor increases to $9.6\ \text{V}$.

Calculate the increase in energy ΔE stored in the capacitor.

$\Delta E = \dots\dots\dots\ \text{J}$ [2]

- (c) A sinusoidal a.c. power supply is connected to the input of a bridge rectifier. The output of the rectifier is connected to a load resistor.

- (i) Complete the circuit in Fig. 4.2 by adding a capacitor to smooth the p.d. across the load resistor.

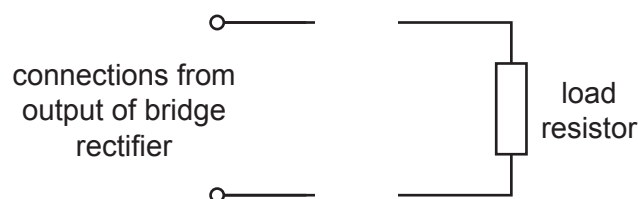


Fig. 4.2

[1]

- (ii) The variation with time t of the p.d. V of the smoothed output is shown in Fig. 4.3.

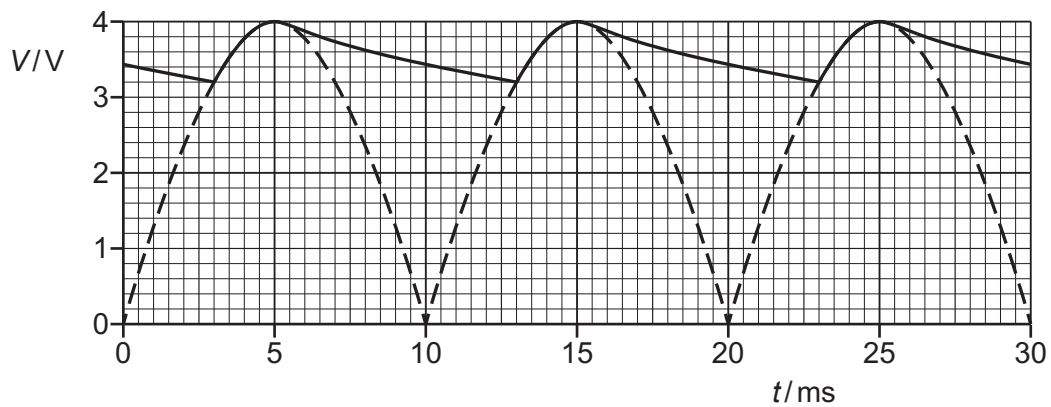


Fig. 4.3

Determine the time constant, in ms, of the smoothing circuit.

time constant = ms [3]

- (d) A sinusoidal a.c. power supply has a maximum power of 16 W.

State the value of the mean power when the output of the power supply is:

- (i) full-wave rectified

mean power = W [1]

- (ii) half-wave rectified.

mean power = W [1]

[Total: 10]

- 2 A circuit contains a power supply that provides a sinusoidal alternating input voltage V_{IN} . There is an output voltage V_{OUT} across a load resistor R , as shown in Fig. 7.1.

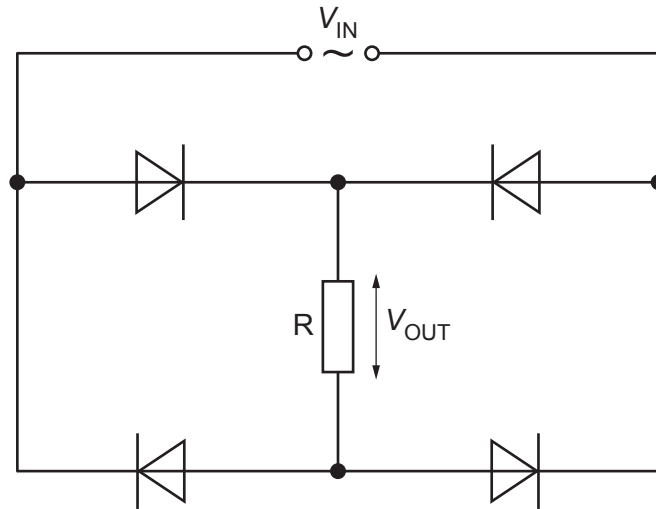


Fig. 7.1

- (a) State the purpose of the circuit in Fig. 7.1.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) Fig. 7.2 shows the variation of V_{OUT} with time t .

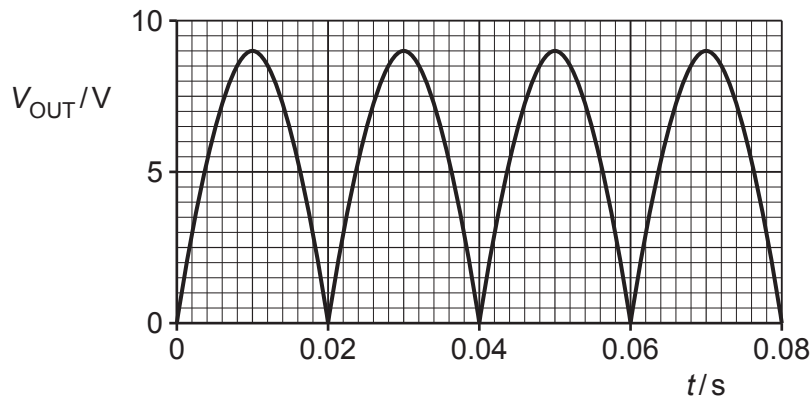


Fig. 7.2

- (i) The load resistor R has a resistance of $370\ \Omega$.

Show that the maximum power dissipated in R is 0.22 W .

[2]

- (ii) On Fig. 7.3, sketch the variation with t of the power P dissipated in R .

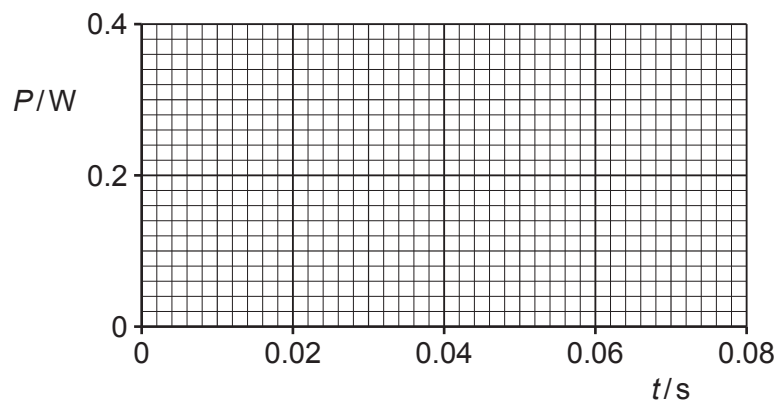


Fig. 7.3

[3]

- (iii) Calculate the mean power dissipated in R .

mean power = W [1]

- (c) The circuit of Fig. 7.1 is disconnected, and R is connected directly across the power supply.

Explain, without calculation, how the mean power now dissipated in R compares with the answer in (b)(iii).

.....

 [2]

[Total: 10]



- 3 (a) (i) State what is meant by rectification of an alternating voltage.

.....
 [1]

- (ii) State the difference between half-wave rectification and full-wave rectification.

.....

 [2]

- (b) (i) Complete Fig. 6.1 to show a circuit that produces half-wave rectification of an alternating input voltage V_{IN} to produce output voltage V_{OUT} across the resistor R .

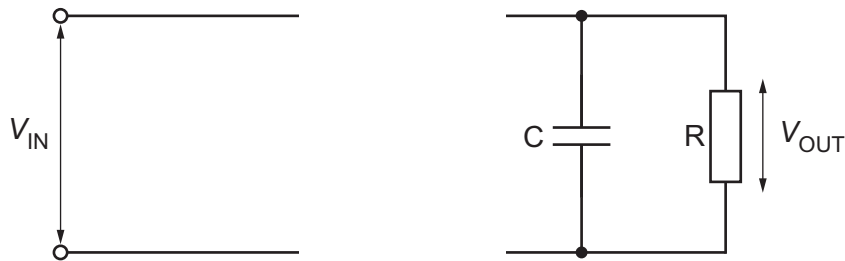


Fig. 6.1

[2]

- (ii) State the purpose of the capacitor C in the circuit of Fig. 6.1.

.....
 [1]

- (c) The input voltage V_{IN} in Fig. 6.1 is a square wave. Fig. 6.2 shows the variation of V_{IN} with time t .

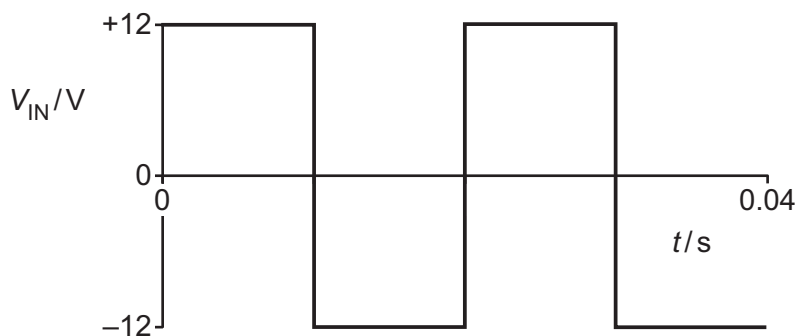


Fig. 6.2





Fig. 6.3 shows the variation of V_{OUT} with t .

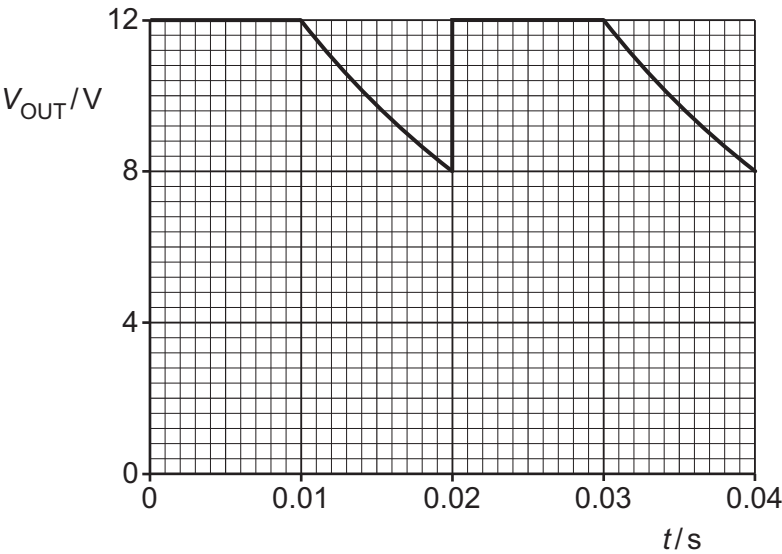


Fig. 6.3

The maximum energy stored in the capacitor is 0.041 J.

(i) Show that the capacitance of C is 570 μF .

[2]

(ii) Determine the resistance of R.

resistance = Ω [3]

[Total: 11]





- 4 (a) State what is meant by the frequency of an alternating current.

.....
..... [1]

- (b) An alternating current I in a resistor of resistance $680\ \Omega$ varies with time t according to

$$I = 3.5 \sin(40\pi t)$$

where I is in A and t is in s.

- (i) Show that the period of the alternating current is 50 ms.

[1]

- (ii) On Fig. 8.1, sketch the variation of I with t between $t = 0$ and $t = 100$ ms.

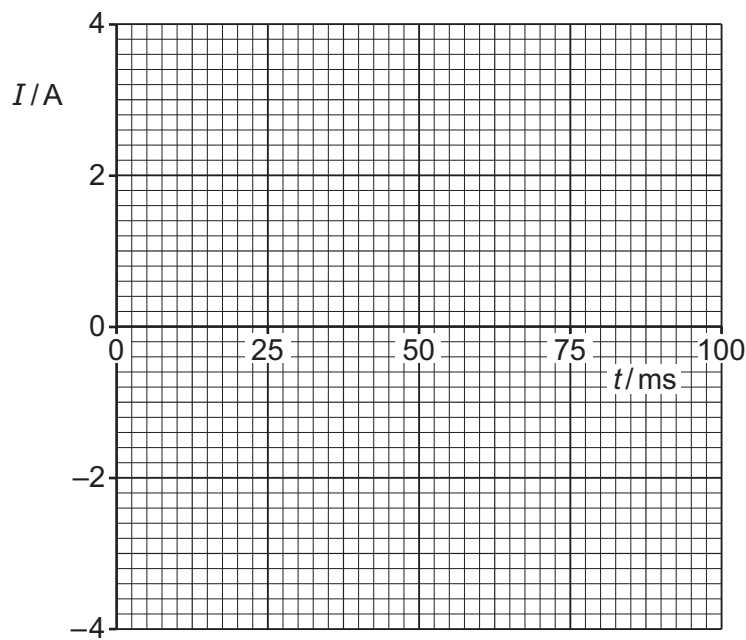


Fig. 8.1

[3]





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(iii) Determine the root-mean-square (r.m.s.) current in the resistor.

r.m.s. current =A [1]

(c) Use data from (b), including your answer in (b)(iii), to show by calculation that the mean power in the $680\,\Omega$ resistor is half of the peak power.

[3]

[Total: 9]



- 1 (a) A photon has an energy of $3.11 \times 10^{-19} \text{ J}$.

Calculate the momentum of the photon.

momentum = N s [2]

- (b) A laser beam has a power of 350 mW. The light from the laser has a wavelength of 640 nm.

- (i) Determine the number of photons emitted by the laser in a time of 1.0 s.

number = [2]

- (ii) The laser beam is incident normally on a surface that absorbs all of the photons.

Show that the force F exerted on the surface by the laser beam is given by

$$F = \frac{P}{c}$$

where P is the power of the laser beam and c is the speed of light.

[2]

- (c) Light of a single wavelength is incident on the surface of different metals. The work function energy of the metals is given in Table 7.1.

Table 7.1

metal	work function energy / eV
tungsten	4.49
magnesium	3.68
potassium	2.26

- (i) Explain the term threshold wavelength.

.....

.....

..... [1]

- (ii) For the metals in Table 7.1, calculate the value of the largest threshold wavelength.

threshold wavelength = m [2]

[Total: 9]

- 2 (a) State what is meant by a photon.

.....

 [2]

- (b) Fig. 8.1 shows a tube in which X-rays are produced at a metal target.

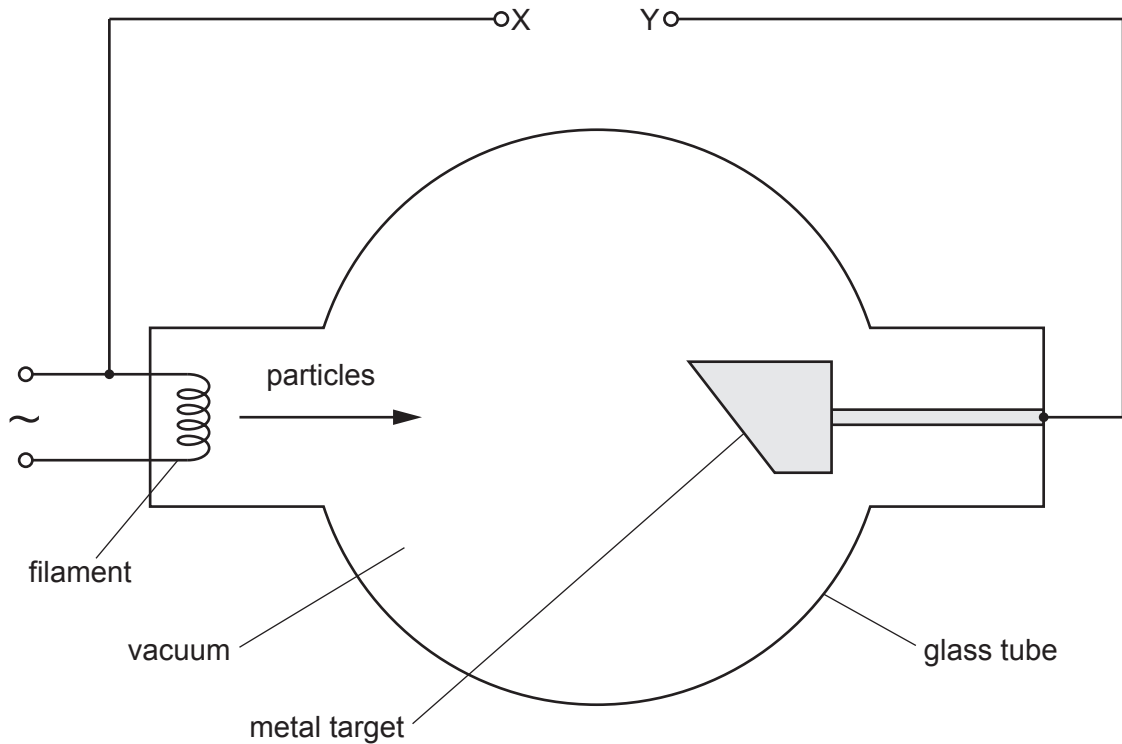


Fig. 8.1

Particles are accelerated from the filament to the target by a constant high voltage applied across the terminals X and Y.

- (i) State the name of the particles.

..... [1]

- (ii) On Fig. 8.1, use + and – signs to label terminals X and Y to indicate the polarity of the high voltage. [1]

2024 Paper 4 Questions by Topic

(c) For an accelerating voltage of 32 kV in Fig. 8.1, determine:

(i) the maximum energy, in MeV, of an X-ray photon produced at the target

maximum photon energy = MeV [1]

(ii) the maximum momentum of an X-ray photon produced at the target

maximum photon momentum = N s [2]

(iii) the minimum wavelength of X-rays produced at the target.

minimum wavelength = m [3]

(d) Explain why X-rays can be used to produce images of internal body structures that have good contrast.

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

[Total: 13]

- 3 Fig. 8.1 shows part of the emission spectrum of visible radiation emitted by hydrogen gas in a star in a distant galaxy.

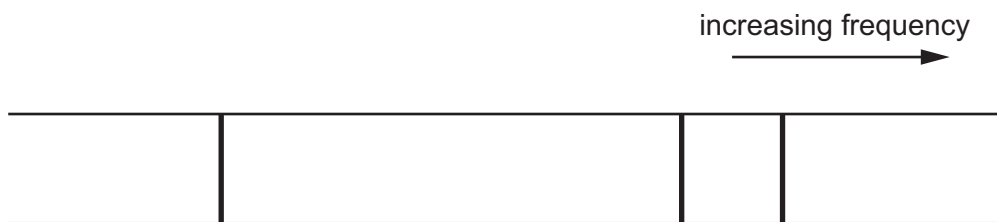


Fig. 8.1

The galaxy is moving away from the Earth at a speed of $6.2 \times 10^6 \text{ m s}^{-1}$.

- (a) (i) Explain how the positions of the lines in the emission spectrum seen by an observer on the Earth differ from the positions shown in Fig. 8.1.

.....

 [2]

- (ii) On Fig. 8.1, draw the three lines in possible positions in the spectrum seen by the observer. [2]

- (b) The lines in Fig. 8.1 correspond to electron transitions down to the energy level -3.40 eV . One of the lines represents emitted radiation of wavelength 488 nm .

- (i) Calculate the energy of a photon of this radiation.

photon energy = J [2]

- (ii) Determine the energy, in eV, of the energy level from which the electron transition originates to cause the emission of this radiation.

energy level = eV [2]





(iii) Determine the wavelength, in nm, of this radiation as detected by the observer on the Earth.

wavelength = nm [2]

(c) A value for the Hubble constant is $2.3 \times 10^{-18} \text{ s}^{-1}$.
Determine the distance of the galaxy from the Earth.

distance = m [2]

[Total: 12]

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- 4 A polished sheet of magnesium in a vacuum emits electrons when it is illuminated by ultraviolet radiation.

(a) State the name of this phenomenon.

..... [1]

- (b) For emission of electrons to occur, the frequency of the ultraviolet radiation must be at least 8.8×10^{14} Hz.

(i) Calculate the work function energy of magnesium.

work function energy = J [2]

- (ii) For ultraviolet radiation with a frequency of 11×10^{14} Hz, calculate the maximum speed of the emitted electrons.

maximum speed = ms^{-1} [3]

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- (c) The frequency f of the ultraviolet radiation incident on the magnesium sheet is varied between $8.0 \times 10^{14} \text{ Hz}$ and $11 \times 10^{14} \text{ Hz}$.

On Fig. 8.1, sketch the variation with f of the maximum kinetic energy E_{MAX} of the emitted electrons. Use the space below for any working that you need.

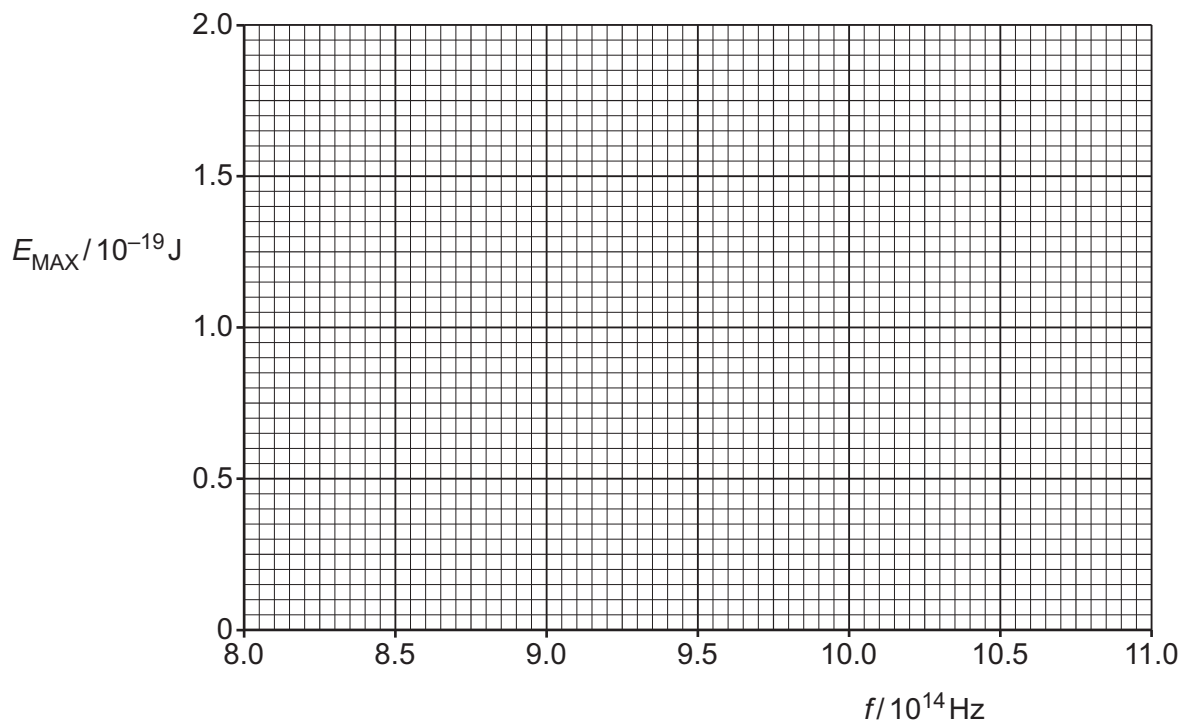


Fig. 8.1

[3]

[Total: 9]





- 5 Electrons in a vacuum are accelerated from rest through a potential difference (p.d.) V to form a beam. The electrons each have mass m and charge q .

The beam is incident on a graphite crystal that acts as a diffraction grating. After passing through the crystal, the beam reaches a fluorescent screen. An interference pattern is observed on this screen.

- (a) Explain what this observation shows about the nature of electrons.

.....
.....
..... [1]

- (b) Determine an expression, in terms of m , q and V , for the momentum p of an electron in the beam.

$$p = \text{.....} [3]$$

- (c) The p.d. through which the electrons are accelerated is now increased to a greater value.

Describe and explain the effect of this change on the interference pattern observed.

.....
.....
..... [2]





- (d) The electrons are now accelerated through different values of V , resulting in pairs of corresponding values for p and the de Broglie wavelength λ .

- (i) On Fig. 9.1, sketch the variation of p with $\frac{1}{\lambda}$.

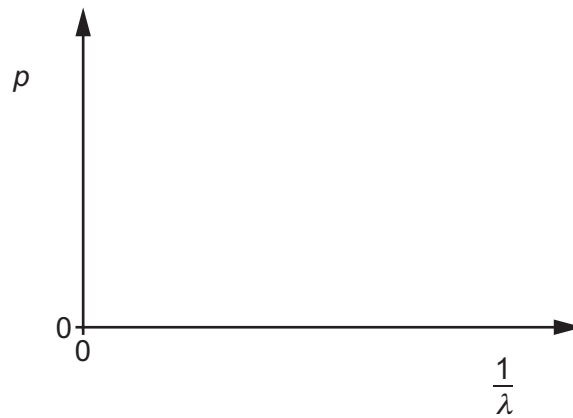


Fig. 9.1

[2]

- (ii) State the name of the quantity represented by the gradient of the line in Fig. 9.1.

..... [1]

[Total: 9]



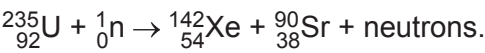
- 1 (a) State what is meant by the binding energy of a nucleus.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) A nucleus of uranium-235 absorbs a neutron and becomes unstable. It then undergoes a fission reaction. One possible reaction is



- (i) Determine the number of neutrons produced in this fission reaction.

number = [1]

- (ii) Data for the binding energies per nucleon for this fission reaction are given in Table 8.1.

Table 8.1

isotope	binding energy per nucleon/MeV
uranium-235	7.59
xenon-142	8.37
strontium-90	8.72

Calculate the energy released, in MeV, from the fission of one nucleus of uranium-235.

energy = MeV [2]

- (iii) The isotope xenon-142 is unstable. The isotope xenon-132 is stable.

Suggest a reason why xenon-142 is unstable.

.....
 [1]

- (iv) Xenon-142 decays into the isotope caesium-142.

A sample initially contains only nuclei of xenon-142. After a time equal to 6.0 s, the ratio

$$\frac{\text{number of decayed nuclei of xenon-142}}{\text{number of undecayed nuclei of xenon-142}}$$

is equal to 31.

Calculate the half-life of xenon-142. Show your working.

half-life = s [3]

[Total: 9]

- 2 (a) Define half-life of a radioactive isotope.

.....
.....
..... [1]

- (b) Radioactive isotope X decays to isotope Y.

A sample contains only nuclei of X at time $t = 0$. Fig. 9.1 shows the variation with t of the numbers of nuclei of X and of Y as the sample decays.

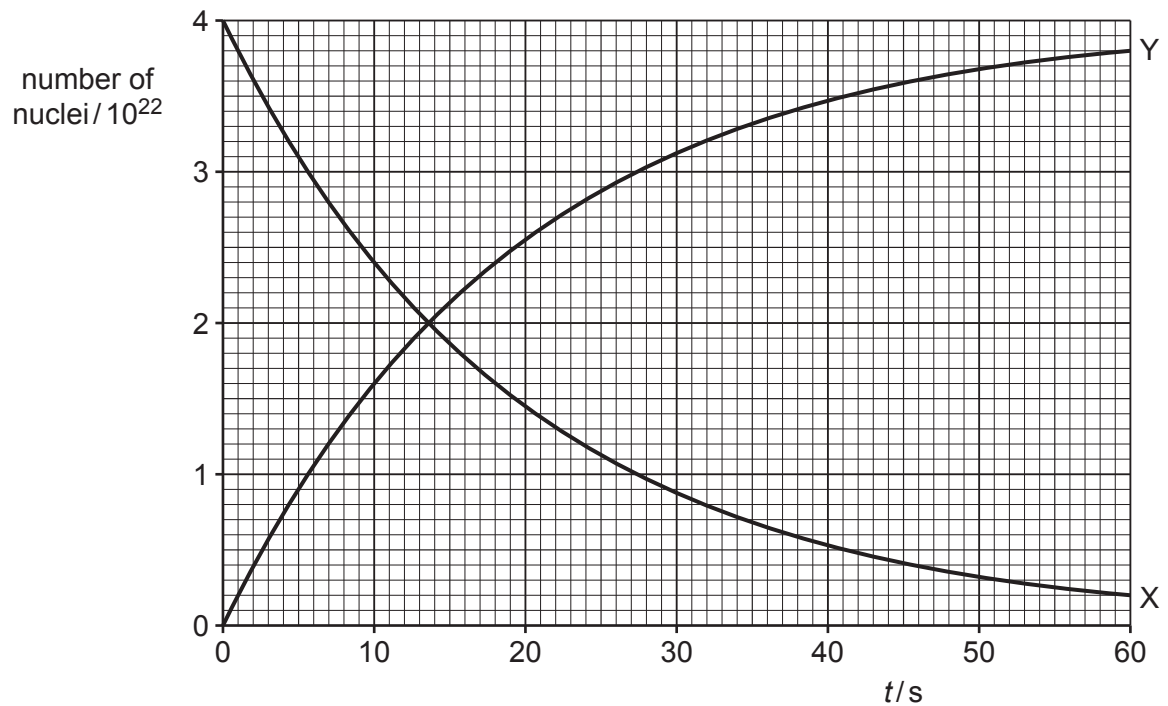


Fig. 9.1

- (i) State the name of the quantity represented by the magnitude of the gradient of line X in Fig. 9.1.

..... [1]

- (ii) State **three** conclusions about X or Y that may be drawn from Fig. 9.1. The conclusions may be qualitative or quantitative. Use the space below for any working that you need.

1

.....

2

.....

3

.....

[3]

- (c) The mass of radioactive isotope X in the sample in (b) is 7.3×10^{-4} kg at time $t = 0$.

Determine the nucleon number of isotope X.

nucleon number = [3]

[Total: 8]



3 (a) State what is meant by the binding energy of a nucleus.

.....

.....

..... [2]

(b) Table 9.1 shows the masses of two sub-atomic particles and a polonium-212 ($^{212}_{84}\text{Po}$) nucleus.

Table 9.1

	mass/u
proton	1.007 276
neutron	1.008 665
polonium-212 nucleus	211.942 749

For the polonium-212 nucleus, determine:

(i) the mass defect Δm , in kg

$\Delta m =$ kg [3]

(ii) the binding energy

binding energy = J [2]

(iii) the binding energy per nucleon.

binding energy per nucleon = J [1]



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- (c) (i) On Fig. 9.1, sketch the variation with nucleon number A of binding energy per nucleon for values of A from 1 to 250.

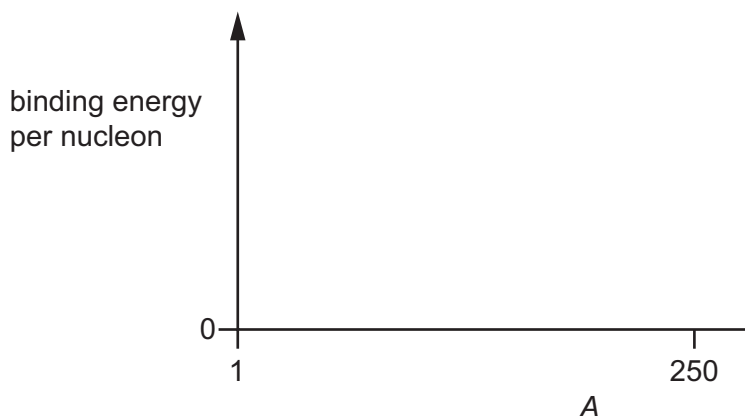


Fig. 9.1

- (ii) On your line in Fig. 9.1, draw an X to show the approximate position of polonium-212. [2]
- (iii) Polonium-212 is radioactive and undergoes alpha-decay. [1]

Suggest and explain, with reference to Fig. 9.1, why the alpha-decay of polonium-212 results in a release of energy.

.....

.....

..... [2]

[Total: 13]





3 (a) Radioactive decay is both random and spontaneous.

(i) State what is meant by random.

.....
..... [1]

(ii) State what is meant by spontaneous.

.....
..... [1]

(iii) State **one** piece of evidence for the random nature of decay.

.....
..... [1]

(b) (i) Describe the differences between nuclear fission and nuclear fusion.

.....
.....
.....
.....
..... [3]

(ii) Explain, with reference to the variation of binding energy per nucleon with nucleon number, why the processes of nuclear fission and nuclear fusion both result in a release of energy.

.....
.....
..... [2]

[Total: 8]



- 1 (a) Electrons in a vacuum are accelerated through a potential difference of 84 kV. The electrons then strike a metal target and X-rays are produced.
- (i) Calculate the minimum wavelength of the X-rays that are produced.

wavelength =m [2]

- (ii) The melting points of two metals are given in Table 9.1.

Table 9.1

metal	melting point/°C
copper	1090
tungsten	3420

Suggest why the metal target is made from tungsten rather than copper.

.....
.....
..... [2]

- (b) An X-ray beam is incident normally on a sample of soft tissue and bone as shown in Fig. 9.1.

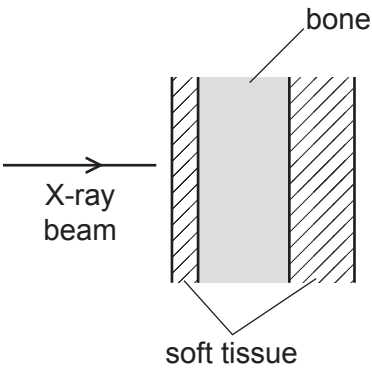


Fig. 9.1

Data for the two materials are given in Table 9.2.

Table 9.2

medium	linear attenuation coefficient μ/cm^{-1}	specific acoustic impedance $Z/10^6\text{ kg m}^{-2}\text{ s}^{-1}$
soft tissue	0.22	1.7
bone	3.0	7.8

The total thickness of soft tissue is x . The total thickness of bone is also x .

The incident intensity of the X-ray beam is I_0 . The transmitted intensity of the X-ray beam is 13% of the incident intensity.

Determine x , in cm.

$x = \dots\dots\dots \text{ cm [3]}$

(c) (i) Define the specific acoustic impedance of a medium.

.....
.....
..... [2]

(ii) Use data from Table 9.2 to calculate the percentage of the intensity of ultrasound that is transmitted at a boundary between soft tissue and bone.

percentage transmitted =% [2]

- (iii) The ultrasound is now incident on the sample of soft tissue and bone shown in Fig. 9.1.

Suggest **two** reasons why the transmitted intensity through the sample is less than the answer in (c)(ii).

1

.....

2

.....

[2]

[Total: 13]



2 (a) Describe how reflected ultrasound pulses may be used to obtain diagnostic information about internal structures.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

(b) (i) Define specific acoustic impedance of a medium.

.....

.....

..... [2]

(ii) Table 10.1 shows some data for water and for glass.

Table 10.1

	density / kg m ⁻³	speed of sound / ms ⁻¹
water	1000	1420
glass	2500	4560

Determine the intensity reflection coefficient for ultrasound that is incident on a water–glass boundary.

intensity reflection coefficient = [3]

[Total: 7]





3 Fluorine-18 ($^{18}_9\text{F}$) decays by beta-plus (β^+) emission with a half-life of 110 minutes.

(a) (i) State the name of the beta-plus particle.

..... [1]

(ii) Show that the decay constant of fluorine-18 is $1.05 \times 10^{-4} \text{ s}^{-1}$.

[1]

(iii) Determine the activity of $2.1 \times 10^{-12} \text{ kg}$ of fluorine-18.

activity = Bq [3]

(b) A small sample of fluorine-18 injected into the body acts as a tracer for use in medical imaging.

(i) Describe how the interaction of a β^+ particle with an electron in the body enables the formation of an image.

.....
.....
.....
.....
..... [3]

(ii) Suggest why 110 minutes is a suitable half-life for a nuclide used as a tracer in medical diagnosis.

.....
.....
..... [2]

[Total: 10]



- 1 (a) The Sun has a surface temperature of 5780 K. The luminosity of the Sun is $3.85 \times 10^{26} \text{ W}$.

(i) Calculate the radius of the Sun.

radius = m [2]

(ii) The Earth is a distance of $1.50 \times 10^{11} \text{ m}$ from the Sun.

Calculate the radiant flux intensity F of the radiation from the Sun at a distance of $1.50 \times 10^{11} \text{ m}$. Give a unit with your answer.

$F = \dots\dots\dots$ unit [2]

(iii) The variation with wavelength of the intensity of radiation emitted from the Sun is shown in Fig. 10.1.



Fig. 10.1

Another star has the same radius as the Sun but has a lower surface temperature.

On Fig. 10.1, sketch a line to show the variation with wavelength of the intensity of the radiation emitted for this star. [2]

(b) A galaxy in the constellation Corona Borealis is moving away from the Earth.

(i) The visible emission spectrum for the Sun is shown in Fig. 10.2.

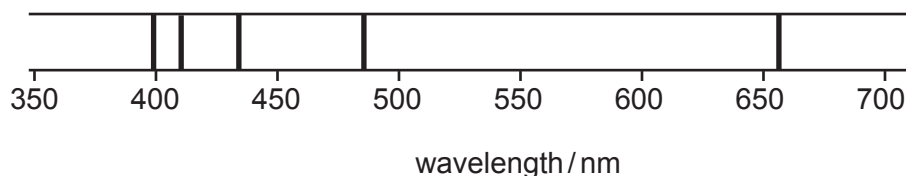


Fig. 10.2

The lines are at wavelengths of 397 nm, 410 nm, 434 nm, 486 nm and 656 nm. The compositions of the Sun and a star in the Corona Borealis galaxy are similar.

On Fig. 10.3, sketch the emission spectrum for the star in the Corona Borealis galaxy as observed from the Earth. No calculations are required.

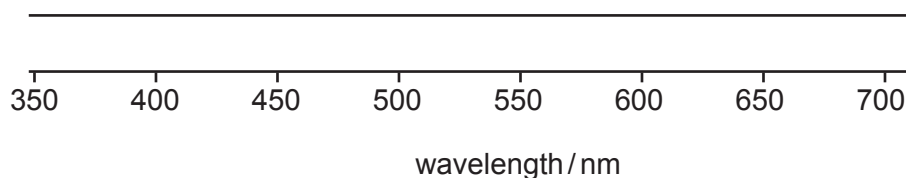


Fig. 10.3

[1]

(ii) The galaxy in Corona Borealis is moving away from the Earth at a speed of $21\,400\text{ km s}^{-1}$.

Use information from (b)(i) to calculate, in nm, the observed wavelength of the lowest visible energy emission for the star in the Corona Borealis galaxy.

wavelength = nm [2]

(iii) The wavelength in (b)(ii) is used to calculate a value for the surface temperature of the star in the Corona Borealis galaxy. The calculation does not give an accurate value.

State and explain whether this value of temperature is too high or too low.

.....

 [1]

[Total: 10]

- 2 (a) (i) State what is meant by the luminosity of a star.

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (ii) Explain how a standard candle in a distant galaxy can be used to determine the distance of the galaxy from an observer.

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

- (b) The Sun has a radius of 6.96×10^8 m and a surface temperature of 5780 K.
Light from the Sun is observed to have a peak intensity at a wavelength of 501 nm.

- (i) Calculate the luminosity of the Sun. Give a unit with your answer.

luminosity = unit [2]

- (ii) Another star emits radiation that has a peak intensity at a wavelength of 624 nm.

Determine the surface temperature of this star.

surface temperature =K [2]

[Total: 9]



3 (a) Explain how redshift leads to the idea that the Universe is expanding.

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

(b) Stars in a distant galaxy emit radiation. The total luminosity of the stars in the galaxy is $1.90 \times 10^{36} \text{ W}$.
The emission spectrum of the radiation contains a line X at a wavelength of 658 nm.

Radiation from the galaxy is observed on the Earth. The observed radiation has a radiant flux intensity of $8.42 \times 10^{-16} \text{ W m}^{-2}$. In the observed emission spectrum, line X is at a wavelength of 726 nm.

Determine:

(i) the distance d of the galaxy from the Earth

$d = \text{..... m [2]}$

(ii) the speed v of the galaxy relative to the Earth.

$v = \text{..... ms}^{-1} [2]$

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(c) Observations of many galaxies, such as the one in (b), lead to many pairs of values of d and v . Plotting these values reveals a trend.

(i) On Fig. 10.1, sketch the variation of v with d .

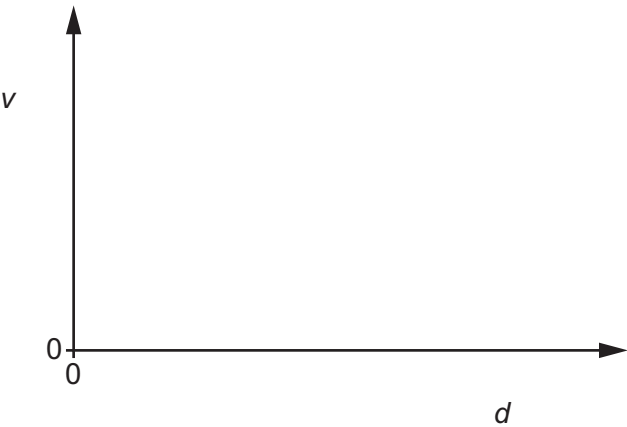


Fig. 10.1

[2]

(ii) State the name of the quantity represented by the gradient of the line in Fig. 10.1.

..... [1]

[Total: 10]

